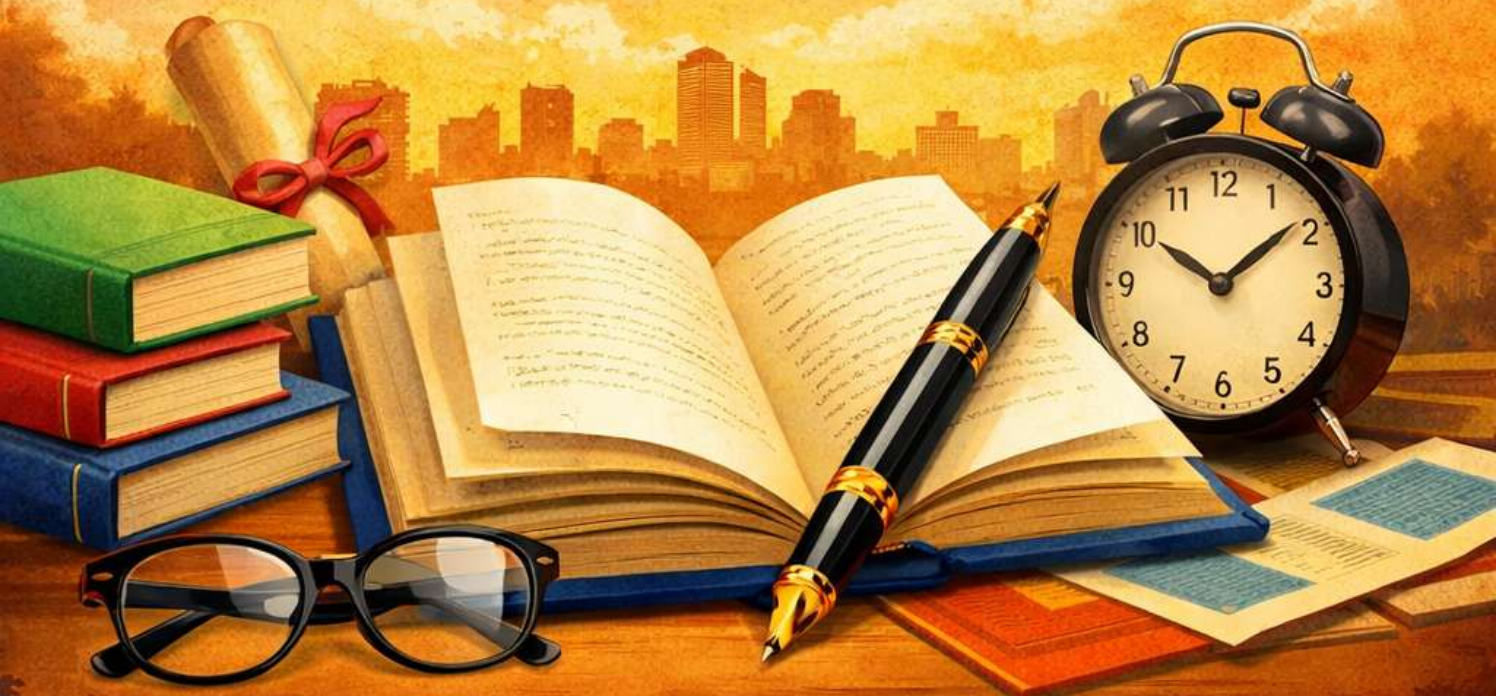


50+ Unseen Passage

For Class 12

English Practice



By Thunderstudy

Not For CUET

In Loving Memory Of



1999 – 2025

In Loving Memory Of Thunderstudy Owner's Sister

This book is lovingly created in memory of Thunderstudy's owner's sister, who's untimely passing at the age of 26 due to a heart attack has left us heartbroken. Her love, kindness, and gentle spirit were the guiding light of our lives.

Known for her unwavering support, encouragement, and the joy she brought to everyone around her, she inspired us all.

With this book, we honor her cherished memory, aiming to continue her legacy of care, encouragement, and educational support. Thunderstudy is dedicated to carrying on her dream of making a positive impact in the lives of students.

Forever in our hearts



SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) Travel, they say, broadens the mind, but who exactly are ‘they’ ? These mysterious sages seem to know a thing or two about the transformative power of packing a suitcase and jetting off to distant lands. As Mark Twain wisely put it, “Travel is fatal to prejudice, bigotry and narrow-mindedness.” Indeed, leaving behind your familiar surroundings and completely involving yourself in a new culture is like enrolling in a crash course in the School of Life.
- (2) Take, for instance, the confusing world of foreign languages. You might think you know how to navigate a city because you can book a hotel and call a taxi, but try finding your way through a maze of winding streets in an old European town. Suddenly, “Where is the train station ?” seems sadly not enough. It’s a humbling experience, much like realising that ‘piazza’ is Italian for ‘square’ and not a type of pizza. But therein lies the beauty: each navigational blunder is a lesson, each wrong turn a new entry in your personal map of life.
- (3) Then there are the historical landmarks. Visiting the Colosseum isn’t just a chance to take an Instagram-worthy selfie; it’s a real-life history lesson that textbooks can only dream of. As you stand in the shadow of this ancient arena, you might find yourself daydreaming about gladiators and emperors, only to be jolted back to reality by a selfie stick to the face. Travel has a way of making history real, even if it sometimes includes the odd bruise.
- (4) Moreover, travel teaches resilience and adaptability. Missed flights, lost luggage, and questionable hotel rooms can turn even the most meticulously planned vacation into a comedy of errors. Yet, these are the moments that foster growth and creativity. Who knew you could fashion a comb out of a hotel toothbrush and a bit of resourcefulness.
- (5) Travel is a passport to a world of knowledge, where every stamp tells a story and every journey is a chapter in the grand, unfinished novel of your life. So, next time you find yourself lost in a foreign city, remember: you’re not just a tourist; you’re a student of the world, and the curriculum is as vast as your curiosity.



Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) According to Mark Twain, how does travel influence people ? 1
- (ii) How does the author use the metaphor of 'crash course in the School of Life' to interpret the value of travel ? 1
- (iii) The comparison of 'navigational blunder' to a 'lesson', in the context of travel, primarily highlights : 1
- (A) the inevitability of getting lost while travelling.
- (B) the educational value of travel experiences.
- (C) the frustration of not knowing a foreign language.
- (D) the importance of planning every detail of a trip.
- (iv) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (4) to prove that travel promotes creativity. 1
- (v) The significance of historical landmarks in the context of travel, according to the passage, is _____. 1
- (vi) Give two instances of the author's resilience and adaptability during his travels. 2
- (vii) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (4) : 1
- fragility : weakness : : _____ : strength
- (A) adaptability
- (B) ingenuity
- (C) resilience
- (D) creativity
- (viii) How does the following statement define a traveller ? (paragraph (5)) 1
- 'You're not just a tourist; you're a student of the world, and the curriculum is as vast as your curiosity.'
- (ix) Reflect on the author's perspective on travel as an educational journey. How does this viewpoint of the author challenge conventional forms of education ? 2
- (x) Complete the sentence suitably : 1
- The author refers to travel as a passport to the world of knowledge because _____.



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) **Introduction :** One of the unfortunate paradoxes of our lives today is that despite adequate food production and unimaginable advances in technology, one in three persons worldwide is not getting enough of the right food to eat and approximately 800 million of seven billion sleep hungry every night. Not surprisingly, this makes poor diet the No. 1 risk factor by far, for the global burden of disease.
- (2) **Findings :** Poor diets globally are more responsible for ill health as compared with the combined effect of drugs, tobacco and alcohol. Women and children continue to be the most vulnerable, with 156 million stunted children in the world and 40% of women anaemic. Add to this the fact that the world adds 2,00,000 new people to its population every day, of which India adds 58,000. This translates to the need to feed two billion more people by 2050 and to support a higher demand for major crops, estimated to increase by 50%, from 2.5 to 3.5 billion tonnes.
- (3) **Purpose :** Target 3 for Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 12 is to “halve per capita global food waste at the retail and consumer level, and reduce food losses along production and supply chains, including post-harvest losses”. Food loss is valued at \$ 1 trillion globally by the Food and Agriculture Organisation, enough to feed the 800 million who sleep hungry every night. The SDGs have put the spotlight on food loss and waste, prompting discussions on solutions through better farming practices, technology, information, and consumer behaviour changes.
- (4) **Implications :** In developed countries, ‘food waste’ occurs more at the consumer household level, whereas in emerging economies, it is the supply chain that leads to ‘food loss’ during harvest, storage or transit, due to poor infrastructure and inadequately aligned processes. Investment in creating adequate cold storage capacity alone can significantly reduce food loss. Food loss is also nutrition loss, productivity loss, and GDP loss. India, for instance, loses 40% of its food, translating to approximately \$ 7.5 billion .
- (5) **Suggestions :** To provide a dignified quality of life, India must enhance agricultural productivity, diversify crops, and eliminate food loss and waste with a firm resolve and timely action. Investments in infrastructure, information systems, technology, and public-private partnerships are critical. Minimising food loss has the potential to be transformative in multiple ways.



Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Complete the following suitably.

The 'paradox' that the author mentions in the introduction refers to _____.

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- (ii) Analyse why poor diet is the No. 1 risk factor for diseases globally.

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- (iii) What would the following be classified as ?

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'This makes poor diet the No. 1 risk factor by far for the global burden of disease.'

Select the appropriate response.

- (A) Primary purpose (B) Secondary objective
(C) Method of analysis (D) Research outcome

- (iv) Target 3 for Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 12 is to :

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- (A) produce enough food to feed the 800 million who sleep hungry every night.
(B) reduce food waste worth \$ 1 trillion globally.
(C) reduce per capita global food waste by 50% at all levels.
(D) reduce per capita global food waste by 50% along production and supply chains.

- (v) Discuss the difference in food waste with regard to developed countries and emerging economies. Answer in about 40 words.

2

- (vi) Paragraph (2) includes the words – effect and demand. Classify the following sentences as 'effect' or 'demand'.

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Sentence 1 – 156 million stunted children in the world.

Sentence 2 – This translates to the need to feed two billion more people by 2050.

- (vii) Analyse what impact food loss has on a country's economy.

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- (viii) India can ensure a dignified way of life for its citizens by :

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Reading Skills

(22 marks)

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- (1) Travel, they say, broadens the mind, but who exactly are ‘they’ ? These mysterious sages seem to know a thing or two about the transformative power of packing a suitcase and jetting off to distant lands. As Mark Twain wisely put it, “Travel is fatal to prejudice, bigotry and narrow-mindedness.” Indeed, leaving behind your familiar surroundings and completely involving yourself in a new culture is like enrolling in a crash course in the School of Life.
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(A) _____

(B) _____



SECTION A

Reading

(20 marks)

1. Read the following passage given below carefully :

12

Recently, when I visited the US, I had to speak to a crowd of both students and highly successful people. I always prefer interacting with the audience, so I opened the floor to questions.

After several questions were asked, a middle-aged man stood to speak. 'Ma'am, I believe that you have studied abroad as you are very confident and clear in communicating your thoughts. You are absolutely at ease while talking to us...'

My mind went back to 1968. I was a seventeen-year-old girl with an abundance of courage, confidence and the dream to become an engineer. I came from an educated, though middle-class, conservative Brahmin family. My father was a professor of obstetrics and gynaecology in Karnataka Medical College at Hubli, while my mother was a schoolteacher before she got married.

I finished my pre-university exams with excellent marks and told my family that I wanted to pursue engineering. I had always been fascinated with science, even more so with its application. Engineering was one of those branches of science that would allow me to utilize my creativity, especially in design. But it was as if I had dropped a bomb inside our house.

My grandfather, a history teacher and my first guru to teach me reading and writing, only mildly opposed it. 'My child, you are wonderful at history. Why can't you do something in this field ? You could be a great scholar one day.'

My mother, who was extremely proficient in mathematics, said, 'You are good in math. Why don't you complete your post-graduation in mathematics and get a job as a professor ? You can easily work in a college after you get married instead of being a hard-core engineer struggling to balance family and work.'



My father, a liberal man who believed in education for women, thought for a moment and said, 'I think that you should pursue medicine. You are excellent with people and languages. To tell you the truth, I don't know much about engineering. We don't have a single engineer in our family. It is a male-dominated industry and you may not find another girl in your class. What if you have to spend four years without a real friend to talk to? Think about it. However, the decision is yours and I will support you.'

However, I didn't care. As a student of history, I had read Hiuen Tsang's book *Si-Yu-Ki*. Hiuen Tsang was a Buddhist monk and scholar who travelled to India in 629 A.D. Before Tsang's travel to India, everybody discouraged him from making the journey on foot, but he refused to listen and decided to go. In time, he became famous for his seventeen-year-long journey to India. Taking courage from Tsang, I told my family, 'I want to do engineering. Come what may, I am ready for the consequences of my actions.'

I filled out the application form for B.V.B. College of Engineering and Technology, submitted it and soon received the news that I had been selected to the college on the basis of my marks. I was ecstatic, but little did I know that the college staff was discomfited by this development.

The Principal at the time was B.C. Khanapure, who happened to know my father. They both met at a barber shop one day and the Principal expressed his genuine anguish at what he perceived to be an awkward situation. He told my father, 'Doctor Sahib, I know that your daughter is very intelligent and that she has been given admission only because of merit, but I'm afraid we have some problems. She will be the only girl in college. It is going to be difficult for her. First, we don't have a ladies' toilet on campus. We don't have a ladies' room for her to relax either. Second, our boys are young with raging hormones and I am sure that they will trouble her. They may not do anything in front of the staff but they will definitely do something later. They may not cooperate with her or help her because they are not used to talking to girls. As a father of four daughters, I am concerned about yours too. Can you tell her to change her mind for her own sake?'

My father replied, 'I agree with you, Professor Sahib. I know you mean well, but my daughter is hell-bent on pursuing engineering. Frankly, she's not doing anything wrong. So I have decided to let her pursue it.'

'In that case, Doctor Sahib, I have a small request. Please ask her to wear a sari to college as it is a man's world out there and the sari will be an appropriate dress for the environment she will be in. She should not talk to the boys unnecessarily because that will give rise to rumours and that's never good for a girl in our society. Also, tell her to avoid going to the college canteen and spending time there with the boys.'



My father came back and told me about this conversation. I readily agreed to all of the requests since I had no intention of changing my mind.

Eventually, I would become friendly with some of the boys, but I always knew where to draw the line. The truth is that it were these same boys who would teach me some of life's lessons later, such as the value of keeping a sense of perspective, the importance of taking it easy every now and then and being a good sport. Many of the boys, who are now older gentlemen, are like my brothers even after fifty years! Finally, it was the lack of ladies' toilets on campus that made me understand the difficulty faced by many women in India due to the insufficiency or sheer absence of toilets. Eventually, this would lead me to build more than 13,000 toilets in Karnataka alone!

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer any *twelve* out of the fifteen questions given below : $12 \times 1 = 12$

- (i) Why did the speaker open the floor to questions ?
 - (A) Felt at ease while talking to a crowd of people
 - (B) To break the ice
 - (C) To begin an inactive session with the audience
 - (D) To make an open floor plan
- (ii) A middle-aged man believed that she had studied abroad because the speaker was _____ and _____.
- (iii) The speaker's parents were
 - (A) mathematicians
 - (B) nature lovers
 - (C) educationists
 - (D) philanthropists
- (iv) At seventeen, the speaker exhibited certain outstanding personality traits. What are they ?
- (v) The speaker realized the difficulty faced by many women in India due to the insufficiency or sheer absence of toilets. Was it her sympathy or empathy that led her to build 13,000 toilets in the state of Karnataka ?
- (vi) What does the speaker mean when she says, 'I had always been fascinated with science, even more so with its application' ?
 - (A) Engineering uses science to solve problems and she was interested in that.
 - (B) She was happy to challenge the status quo.
 - (C) She did not like studying the humanities.
 - (D) She had a great love for math and wanted to apply for that course.



- (vii) The speaker's determination to pursue engineering shows that she was :
- (A) keen to follow the footsteps of her parents.
 - (B) very daring and loved challenges.
 - (C) easily influenced by conservative ideas.
 - (D) a fighter for equal rights and equal pay.
- (viii) 'I want to do engineering. Come what may, I am ready for the consequences of my actions.'
- This statement by the speaker shows she is
- (A) arrogant
 - (B) docile
 - (C) casual
 - (D) determined
- (ix) Which of the following is **not** true about Hiuen Tsang ?
- (A) He travelled to India in 629 AD.
 - (B) He was a Buddhist monk and a scholar.
 - (C) He is famous for his seventeen-year long journey.
 - (D) Everybody encouraged him to make this journey on foot.
- (x) State whether the following opinion is True or False.
- 'The speaker had read Hiuen Tsang's book' '*Si-Yu-Ki*', and it influenced her decision-making.'
- (xi) The Principal of B.V.B. College of Engineering and Technology explained some of the problems the daughter would face because she would be the only girl student in the college. What are they ?
- (xii) What were the conditions the speaker had to follow as the only girl student of B.V.B. Engineering College ?
- (xiii) Select an idiom from the passage which means "to set a limit on what one is willing to do or allow to happen".
- (xiv) The following are the various themes on the speaker's everyday struggles and victories, large and small, except for :
- (A) Courage, self-confidence and a dream to be an engineer
 - (B) Breaking barriers
 - (C) Reading Hiuen Tsang's travel to Asia
 - (D) Life's lessons learnt from classmates



- (xv) Some of the lessons learnt by the speaker from her classmates and the college campus are :

Statement 1 : The value of keeping a sense of perspective, importance of taking it easy every now and then and being a good sport.

Statement 2 : Lack of ladies' toilets on college campus increases dropout rates among students.

- (A) Both 1 and 2 are correct.
(B) Both 1 and 2 are incorrect.
(C) 1 is correct and 2 is incorrect.
(D) 1 is incorrect and 2 is correct.

2. Read the poem 'The True Knowledge' by Oscar Wilde given below :

4

The True Knowledge

Oscar Wilde

Thou knowest all; I seek in vain
What lands to till or sow with seed –
The land is black with briar and weed,
Nor cares for falling tears or rain.

Thou knowest all; I sit and wait
With blinded eyes and hands that fail,
Till the last lifting of the veil
And the first opening of the gate.

Thou knowest all; I cannot see.
I trust I shall not live in vain,
I know that we shall meet again
In some divine eternity.

Based on your understanding of the poem, answer **four** out of the five questions given below : $4 \times 1 = 4$

- (i) What is the mood in the first stanza of the poem ?
- (A) optimism and jubilance
(B) despair and lack of purpose
(C) trust and hope
(D) solace and resolution



- (ii) “The land is black with briar and weed” is a metaphor for :
- (A) guidance and counselling
 - (B) helplessness and despair
 - (C) resolution and peace
 - (D) uncertainty and resolution
- (iii) What is the difference in the mood of the first stanza of the poem and the last stanza of the poem ?
- (iv) Complete the sentence appropriately.
‘Despite the desperation, the speaker does not give up _____ .
- (v) True knowledge is :
- (A) to know the value of time
 - (B) to learn and observe
 - (C) a quest for purpose and reliance on a higher power
 - (D) to have an open mind and desire to enjoy all the material comforts

3. Read the passage given below :

4

The elephant population in India stands at 25,000 to 30,000, earning the species an “endangered” status. Their range today is estimated to be only 3·5% of what it was earlier, being restricted to the Himalayan foothills, the northeast, some forests of central India, and hilly forests of Western and Eastern Ghats.

Frequent movement of elephants between their habitable zones brings them into contact with roads and railway lines. The range of a female elephant covers about 500 sq. km, and travelling over so much distance in the age of fragmented habitats makes a road or railway crossing very likely.

In a Canadian study attempting to mitigate animal-train collisions, train-triggered warning systems comprising flashing lights and bell sounds were installed at various locations along the tracks. These signals, activated 30 seconds before train arrival, were aimed at conditioning animals to associate the warnings with approaching trains.

The Indian Railways has a vast network of optical fiber cables. These support telecommunications and carry data, and importantly transmit signals for train control. In a recently introduced system called Gajraj, geophonic sensors on these OFC lines are tuned to pick up the vibrations of the deep and resonant footsteps of passing elephants.



This AI-based intrusion detection system analyses data from the sensors, extracting relevant features such as frequency components and duration of vibration. If elephant-specific vibrations are detected, an alert is promptly sent to locomotive drivers in the area, and train speeds are reduced. The system is now operational in the Alipurduar area of north West Bengal, which has been the site of several tragic accidents in the past.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer any **four** out of the five questions given below : $4 \times 1 = 4$

- (i) To mitigate animal-train collisions in Canada, _____ were installed along the tracks.

(A) Train-triggered warning systems
(B) Optical fiber cables
(C) AI-based intrusion detection systems
(D) Vibrators

- (ii) *Statement 1* : Frequent movement of elephants between fragmented habitats is common.

Statement 2 : A female elephant covers about 500 km between their habitat zones, makes a road or railway crossing very unlikely.

(A) Both 1 and 2 are correct.
(B) 1 is correct and 2 is incorrect.
(C) Both 1 and 2 are incorrect.
(D) 1 is incorrect and 2 is correct.

- (iii) The word 'intrusion' suggests :

(A) withdrawal (B) encroachment
(C) confrontation (D) abandonment

- (iv) Complete the sentence appropriately.

'Geophonic sensors on optical fiber cable lines are tuned to pick up the vibrations of the deep and resonant footsteps of passing elephants.'

This new system is called _____ .

- (v) State a point in support of the given opinion.

'AI helps the locomotive drivers to reduce speed when elephants cross the railway lines.'



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SECTION – A

(READING SKILLS)

(22 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully : 12 M

- (1) Marketing is all about creativity and expression, so it must be an art, right? Not necessarily. While marketers once relied purely on instinct, they now rely on data-driven insights. On top of that, cutting-edge technologies and analytics have shifted the focus of marketing farther toward the science side of the spectrum. Armed with so much data, marketers can now track the impact of money spent on their bottom line.
- (2) In today's world, the best approach to marketing combines both disciplines. And there's a distinct balance to the craft – a strategic mix of interpersonal empathy and tactical analysis. Neither side of the mix can be isolated or ignored, or the results will not be encouraging. Psychologists believe the brain is separated into two distinct functions : the left-brain and the right-brain. The right side of the brain is responsible for creative thinking and artistic intuition.



- (3) As an art, marketing is all about understanding the nuances of human behaviour and determining how to make an emotional connection with the customer. More importantly, some level of art is needed to create brand standards for your company, including the logo, messaging, and overall visual identity for a brand.
- (4) Right-brained marketers focus on the creative – the copy, graphics and emotions tied to the message. The science side of marketing tells us to let the data guide what strategies will be most effective. Marketers are now reporting the need for digital-first expertise including digital proficiency, data analysis, and data science. With science, marketers adopt an outcome-centric mindset that helps them curate smarter campaigns. Over the past few years, there has been an evolving prioritization on data-savvy talent. In 2020 and beyond, brands will need to focus on recruiting talent that can understand the complexities of AI and machine technologies.
- (5) But when we reflect on earlier times, marketing was defined as the predominance of traditional advertising, like television, newspaper, and direct mail. Today, it ropes in digital channels, social media, mobile devices, and integrated, complex campaigns. And just as consumers today are more tech-savvy, employees should be able to match – and exceed – their expertise. It's important that brands continue to prioritize creative, engaging campaign messages while also focusing on key insights and performance metrics for optimal results.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above :

- (i) According to paragraph 1, how does the author describe the evolution of marketing ? 2
- (ii) Choose ONE of the following statements that aptly reflects the point of view of the writer. 1
- (a) In the field of marketing, there is a conflict between Art and Science.
- (b) Art and Science should work in tandem to do effective marketing.



- (iii) Provide ONE textual evidence with reference to paragraph 3 to support that marketing is an art. 1
- (iv) Based on the passage, assess the way data and digital platforms have transformed the field of marketing and employment. 2
- (v) _____ cutting-edge technologies and analytics have shifted the focus of marketing. (Para 1) 1
By 'cutting-edge technologies', the writer refers to _____.
- (vi) Complete the analogy with ONE word from paragraph 2 : 1
included : incorporated : _____ : secluded
(A) approach
(B) empathy
(C) isolated
(D) intuition
- (vii) 'Marketing is all about understanding the nuances of human behaviour. (Para 3) 1
The writer uses the word 'nuances' to denote
(A) man's appreciation for art.
(B) man's preference for branded clothes.
(C) the complexities of human character.
(D) human inclination for analytical approach.
- (viii) Complete the following based on your understanding of the above passage : 1
According to the writer, modern marketing is built on both _____ and _____.
(ix) '_____ exceed their expertise'. (Para 5) 1
With reference to paragraph 5, what skills do you think the employees should possess to match the demand of the consumers ? 1
- (x) What fascinating fact about the human brain is revealed by the writer in the above passage. 1



2. Case Study : Tourism in India

10 M

- (1) Introduction : India, with its rich cultural heritage, diverse landscapes, and historical sites, attracts millions of tourists each year. Tourism significantly contributes to India's GDP, generating employment and boosting infrastructure. This case study explores factors impacting tourism in India, examines seasonal patterns, and assesses tourist satisfaction through a survey.
- (2) Methodology : The study involved primary data collection through a structured survey targeting 500 tourists across major destinations like Delhi, Jaipur, Goa and Kerala. Additionally, secondary data from government reports and tourism boards were used. The survey included questions about preferences, challenges and satisfaction levels, focusing on various demographics, including international and domestic tourists.
- (3) Survey Examination : Tourists were surveyed on travel preferences, challenges encountered, accommodation satisfaction and cultural experiences. Feedback highlighted India's appeal due to its history and cultural diversity, but also noted issues like infrastructure gaps and pollution.
- (4) Results : The study found that most tourists preferred historical sites and beaches. International tourists were drawn to heritage sites, while domestic tourists preferred nature destinations. Satisfaction was high among tourists who experienced local culture, but infrastructure issues and overcrowding at key locations were common complaints. Overall, 85% of tourists expressed a desire to revisit.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably.

1

In the introduction, the researcher links tourism to India's GDP to highlight _____.



- (ii) What would the following be classified as ? 1
The study involved primary data collection through a structured survey
Select the appropriate response.
(A) Primary purpose (B) Secondary objective
(C) Method of analysis (D) Research outcome
- (iii) Give two points to support why the study involved primary data and secondary data. 2
- (iv) Paragraph 3 includes words – ‘preferences’ and ‘challenges’.
Classify the following sentences as ‘preference’ or ‘challenge’ :
Sentence 1 : Feedback highlighted India’s appeal due to its history and cultural diversity. 1
Sentence 2 : Also noted issues like infrastructure gaps and pollution. 1
- (v) List any two points tourists were asked about in the survey. 1
- (vi) What were the more preferred destinations ? 1
- (vii) Analyse why though there was satisfaction among tourists, there were some complaints. 1
- (viii) What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insights from the study ? 1
(A) tourists expressed a desire to revisit.
(B) tourist will visit historical sites.
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SECTION – A

(READING SKILLS)

(22 Marks)

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Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably.

1

In the introduction, the researcher links tourism to India's GDP to highlight _____.



- (ii) What would the following be classified as ? 1
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Select the appropriate response.
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SECTION – A (READING SKILLS)

(22 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully : **12 M**

- (1) Having a sense of humour might mean having the ability to entertain other people by making them laugh, but it can also mean having a quick wit that is frequently employed to criticize other people with snide comments. Some might define the sense of humour as the ability to see humour in everyday life or as appreciating the cleverness of puns and other wordplay, and may think it entirely possible to possess a good sense of humour without ever having those around them become aware of it.
- (2) In any case, a sense of humour is a socially valued trait that almost all of us would prefer to have more, rather than less, of – akin to the way that we think about intelligence or good looks. A person with an undeveloped sense of humour lacks a social skill that puts him or her at a severe disadvantage in the hurly-burly of everyday social life.



- (3) Freud thought of humour as an outlet for forbidden impulses, and philosophers ranging from Aristotle to Descartes believed that we are amused by something when it makes us feel superior to other people.
- (4) Evolutionary psychologists believe that humour, along with other creative abilities, such as art and music, evolved as an honest signal of intelligence and genetic quality. The value of such a skill in defusing tense, aggressive situations and in managing alliances and friendships should not be underestimated either.
- (5) Schmoozing with a bunch of new people at a cocktail party is an opportunity to engage in light hearted banter, and other people are grateful when someone is skillful enough to turn a stiff and awkward situation into fun. Cracking jokes, making witty remarks, and engaging in tongue-in-cheek observations about the social world can be like fishing for other minds that connect naturally with one's own. In other words, humour can be a device for connecting people who are operating on the same wavelength.
- (6) Observing the performance of other people in such situations tips you off as to who you might like to get to know better – and who might be best left behind, wallowing in indignation and blank stares. In short, a sense of humour is the Swiss Army Knife of social skills. Perhaps it is indeed a single instrument, but it contains an arsenal of tools – each exquisitely designed for a unique social purpose.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage above :

- (i) How does the author prove in paragraph 1 that sense of humour is a double edged sword ? 1
- (ii) Cite evidences from the passage to prove that sense of humour is a valuable tool to make someone's life better. 2
- (iii) Complete the following sentence suitably with reference to paragraph 3. 1
One significant advantage of humour is that it helps one _____.



- (iv) Provide ONE textual evidence with reference to paragraph 5, how a good sense of humour can be a great ice breaker. 1
- (v) Select the correct option from those given in brackets to fill in the blank : 1
- According to evolutionary psychologists, people with a sense of humour can _____ (trigger / lighten) tense situation.
- (vi) Choose the correct option : 1
- “....humour can be a device for connecting people who are operating on the same wavelength.”
- By the phrase ‘same wavelength’ the author refers to
- (A) people of age group
- (B) people who belong to same line of profession.
- (C) people having similar interests and attitudes.
- (D) people who are working in the same organisation.
- (vii) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph 6 : 1
- advantage : benefit : _____ : anger
- (A) situation
- (B) stare
- (C) indignation
- (D) arsenal
- (viii) In the line perhaps ‘it is indeed a single instrument, but it contains an arsenal of tools.....’ What does the phrase ‘arsenal of tools’ refer to ? 2
- (ix) Provide ONE textual evidence from the text which states lack of sense of humour may prove to be a handicap in one’s life. 1
- (x) An undeveloped sense of humour shows lack of a social skill that puts him or her at a disadvantage.
- Choose the correct option (A) or (B) which reaffirms the idea conveyed in the above extract. 1
- (A) Sense of humour elevates the status of a person in the social circle.
- (B) People with sense of humour are not taken seriously in the society.



2. Read the passage carefully :

10 M

- (1) This report presents findings from the Youth Aspirations in India Survey in which 5,764 youth between the ages of 15 and 30 were asked about their employment, education, and skilling aspirations.
- (2) Indian youth valued higher education. 50 percent of respondents aspire to attain a post-graduate degree, 24 percent a PhD, and 21 percent a bachelor's degree. Only 2 percent of respondents hope to attain a college or vocational diploma as their highest form of education.
- (3) Respondents have a strong preference for attaining higher education degrees. At the same time, there is an awareness of changing skills requirements and an interest in augmenting their skills. 76 percent of youth report being very interested in pursuing a skills development programme. 70 percent of youth identified more employment opportunities as the main motivation for wanting to pursue skills development training.
- (4) A study related to their job preference reveals their strong desire for job security and opportunities for career advancement. It is evident from the following data :

Percentage	Preference
49	Public Sector
23	Private Sector
17	Entrepreneurship

- (5) In the context of technological adoption and digitization, jobs and tasks, along with the competencies required to execute them, are changing. 86 percent of youth feel very or moderately up to date with changes in skills requirements. Yet, 39 percent of youth feel very prepared or prepared for their ideal job, while 16 percent of youth feel either not prepared or very unprepared for their ideal job.



- (6) Female respondents' education and employment aspirations match, if not exceed, those of male respondents. Yet, female respondents face discriminatory biases in hiring, have less paid work experience than their male counterparts, and face greater barriers in pursuing skills development opportunities. 60 percent of female respondents, for example, report having no paid work experience, compared to 54 percent of male respondents. In addition, 15 percent of female respondents report personal biases such as marital status, gender, age, or family background as a main barrier to employment compared to 9 percent of male respondents. While more female respondents report being very interested in participating in a skills development programme, only 19 percent have enrolled in a programme, compared to 26 percent of male respondents.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) As per the survey, Indian youth is broadly focussed on 1
(A) skill development and entrepreneurship.
(B) private sector jobs and technology.
(C) higher education and career opportunities.
(D) vocational diploma and public sector jobs.
- (ii) With reference to paragraph 3, what is the latest trend among Indian youth in preparing themselves for the job market ? 1
- (iii) With reference to the table, state one reason for entrepreneurship being the last preference among Indian youth. 1
- (iv) Cite two evidences from the text to show that gender bias is still a hindrance in the progress of women in society. 2
- (v) Complete the following sentence suitably. 1
The driving force for the Indian youth to join a skill development programme is _____.



- (vi) Paragraph 5 uses words 'competencies' and 'adoption'. Classify the following sentences which talks about 'competency' and which talks about 'adoption'. 1

Sentence – 1 : Ria embraced new technology to gain global market for her paintings.

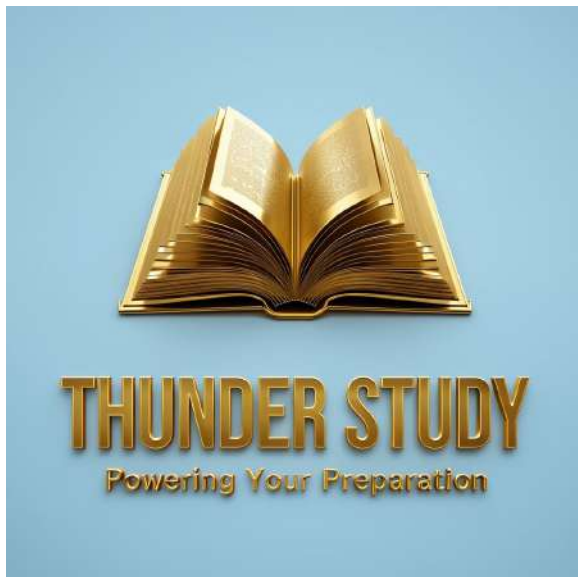
Sentence – 2 : Ria displays her artistic skill through her paintings.

- (vii) Cite two evidences from the text to show that Indian youth is adapting itself to the needs of the job market. 2

- (viii) Choose the correct option : 1

The main road blocks to employment opportunities for females are :

- (i) lack of interest
 - (ii) marriage
 - (iii) lack of opportunities
 - (iv) over qualification
 - (v) family background
- (A) (i) & (ii) (B) (iii) & (iv)
(C) (ii), (iii) & (v) (D) (iv) & (v)





General Instructions :

Read the following instructions very carefully and strictly follow them :

- (i) *This Question Paper has **13** questions. **All** questions are compulsory.*
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SECTION – A (READING SKILLS)

(22 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12 M

- (1) Having a sense of humour might mean having the ability to entertain other people by making them laugh, but it can also mean having a quick wit that is frequently employed to criticize other people with snide comments. Some might define the sense of humour as the ability to see humour in everyday life or as appreciating the cleverness of puns and other wordplay, and may think it entirely possible to possess a good sense of humour without ever having those around them become aware of it.
- (2) In any case, a sense of humour is a socially valued trait that almost all of us would prefer to have more, rather than less, of – akin to the way that we think about intelligence or good looks. A person with an undeveloped sense of humour lacks a social skill that puts him or her at a severe disadvantage in the hurly-burly of everyday social life.
- (3) Freud thought of humour as an outlet for forbidden impulses, and philosophers ranging from Aristotle to Descartes believed that we are amused by something when it makes us feel superior to other people.



- (4) Evolutionary psychologists believe that humour, along with other creative abilities, such as art and music, evolved as an honest signal of intelligence and genetic quality. The value of such a skill in defusing tense, aggressive situations and in managing alliances and friendships should not be underestimated either.
- (5) Schmoozing with a bunch of new people at a cocktail party is an opportunity to engage in light hearted banter, and other people are grateful when someone is skillful enough to turn a stiff and awkward situation into fun. Cracking jokes, making witty remarks, and engaging in tongue-in-cheek observations about the social world can be like fishing for other minds that connect naturally with one's own. In other words, humour can be a device for connecting people who are operating on the same wavelength.
- (6) Observing the performance of other people in such situations tips you off as to who you might like to get to know better – and who might be best left behind, wallowing in indignation and blank stares. In short, a sense of humour is the Swiss Army Knife of social skills. Perhaps it is indeed a single instrument, but it contains an arsenal of tools – each exquisitely designed for a unique social purpose.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage above :

- (i) How does the author prove in paragraph 1 that sense of humour is a double edged sword ? 1
- (ii) Cite evidences from the passage to prove that sense of humour is a valuable tool to make someone's life better. 2
- (iii) Complete the following sentence suitably with reference to paragraph 3. 1
One significant advantage of humour is that it helps one _____.
- (iv) Provide ONE textual evidence with reference to paragraph 5, how a good sense of humour can be a great ice breaker. 1
- (v) Select the correct option from those given in brackets to fill in the blank : 1
According to evolutionary psychologists, people with a sense of humour can _____ (trigger / lighten) tense situation.



- (vi) Choose the correct option : 1
“....humour can be a device for connecting people who are operating on the same wavelength.”
By the phrase ‘same wavelength’ the author refers to
(A) people of age group
(B) people who belong to same line of profession.
(C) people having similar interests and attitudes.
(D) people who are working in the same organisation.
- (vii) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph 6 : 1
advantage : benefit : _____ : anger
(A) situation
(B) stare
(C) indignation
(D) arsenal
- (viii) In the line perhaps ‘it is indeed a single instrument, but it contains an arsenal of tools.....’ What does the phrase ‘arsenal of tools’ refer to ? 2
- (ix) Provide ONE textual evidence from the text which states lack of sense of humour may prove to be a handicap in one’s life. 1
- (x) An undeveloped sense of humour shows lack of a social skill that puts him or her at a disadvantage.
Choose the correct option (A) or (B) which reaffirms the idea conveyed in the above extract. 1
(A) Sense of humour elevates the status of a person in the social circle.
(B) People with sense of humour are not taken seriously in the society.

2. Read the passage carefully : 10 M

- (1) This report presents findings from the Youth Aspirations in India Survey in which 5,764 youth between the ages of 15 and 30 were asked about their employment, education, and skilling aspirations.
- (2) Indian youth valued higher education. 50 percent of respondents aspire to attain a post-graduate degree, 24 percent a PhD, and 21 percent a bachelor’s degree. Only 2 percent of respondents hope to attain a college or vocational diploma as their highest form of education.



- (3) Respondents have a strong preference for attaining higher education degrees. At the same time, there is an awareness of changing skills requirements and an interest in augmenting their skills. 76 percent of youth report being very interested in pursuing a skills development programme. 70 percent of youth identified more employment opportunities as the main motivation for wanting to pursue skills development training.
- (4) A study related to their job preference reveals their strong desire for job security and opportunities for career advancement. It is evident from the following data :

Percentage	Preference
49	Public Sector
23	Private Sector
17	Entrepreneurship

- (5) In the context of technological adoption and digitization, jobs and tasks, along with the competencies required to execute them, are changing. 86 percent of youth feel very or moderately up to date with changes in skills requirements. Yet, 39 percent of youth feel very prepared or prepared for their ideal job, while 16 percent of youth feel either not prepared or very unprepared for their ideal job.
- (6) Female respondents' education and employment aspirations match, if not exceed, those of male respondents. Yet, female respondents face discriminatory biases in hiring, have less paid work experience than their male counterparts, and face greater barriers in pursuing skills development opportunities. 60 percent of female respondents, for example, report having no paid work experience, compared to 54 percent of male respondents. In addition, 15 percent of female respondents report personal biases such as marital status, gender, age, or family background as a main barrier to employment compared to 9 percent of male respondents. While more female respondents report being very interested in participating in a skills development programme, only 19 percent have enrolled in a programme, compared to 26 percent of male respondents.



Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) As per the survey, Indian youth is broadly focussed on 1
(A) skill development and entrepreneurship.
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(D) vocational diploma and public sector jobs.
- (ii) With reference to paragraph 3, what is the latest trend among Indian youth in preparing themselves for the job market ? 1
- (iii) With reference to the table, state one reason for entrepreneurship being the last preference among Indian youth. 1
- (iv) Cite two evidences from the text to show that gender bias is still a hindrance in the progress of women in society. 2
- (v) Complete the following sentence suitably. 1
The driving force for the Indian youth to join a skill development programme is _____.
- (vi) Paragraph 5 uses words 'competencies' and 'adoption'. Classify the following sentences which talks about 'competency' and which talks about 'adoption'. 1
Sentence – 1 : Ria embraced new technology to gain global market for her paintings.
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The main road blocks to employment opportunities for females are :
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(A) (i) & (ii) (B) (iii) & (iv)
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SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) Gossip. All humans partake in some form, despite the age-old adage, *“If you have nothing nice to say, don’t say anything at all.”* Whether it’s workplace chatter, the sharing of family news or group texts between friends, it’s inevitable that anyone who participates in the above, talks about other people.
- (2) People tend to think of gossip as synonymous with malicious rumours, put-downs, or the breathless propagation of a tabloid scoop. But researchers often define it more broadly as “talking about people who aren’t present,” says an assistant professor of psychology. “It’s something that comes very naturally to us” — an integral part of conversation, information sharing, and even community building.
- (3) “It’s not necessarily negative,” adds a professor of psychology. “It can be positive or neutral.” Some researchers argue that gossip helped our ancestors survive. Evolutionary psychologists first pioneered this idea, comparing gossip to the grooming primates engage in as a means of bonding.
- (4) People are usually resistant to thinking about gossip as anything but bad. It is true that there are some types of gossip that should be avoided, such as gossip that is purely harmful and serves no purpose like mean comments on someone’s way of dressing. In such a scenario no one benefits. Gossip can also be both active and passive. Active gossiping refers to directly sharing negative information about someone else. An active gossiper initiates the conversation and actively spreads it. Passive gossiping on the other hand involves more subtle behaviour like hinting, dropping suggestive comments or participating in gossip by listening without actively contributing, but still allowing the gossip to spread through their presence.



- (5) It's interesting to note that gossiping also says something about relationships people have with one another. The act of gossiping often implies a level of trust and closeness with someone, which are key aspects of a good friendship.
- (6) Research has found that gossip can stave off loneliness, while other studies have found it can facilitate bonding and closeness and serve as a form of entertainment. So, keep on talking. And when your conversation turns to gossip, as it inevitably will, remember that some good can come of it — with the right intentions, of course.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably. 1
..... think of gossip as synonymous with malicious rumours, put-downs in paragraph (2).
By the phrase 'put-downs' the writer means _____.
- (ii) Despite the bad reputation of 'gossip', mention any two benefits that it offers. 2
- (iii) Read and complete the following suitably : 1
The phrase – 'It's something that comes very naturally to us' suggests that gossip should not merely be associated with malicious rumours.
Choose the correct response from the two options to complete the sentence.
The concern this phrase points towards is about
A. that some types of gossip should be avoided.
B. that gossip can be viewed as part of our daily interaction and bonding.
- (iv) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (2). 1
Praise : Commend :: _____ : Malevolent
(A) Scoop
(B) Propagation
(C) Malicious
(D) Conversation
- (v) What type of gossip does the author disapprove of and why ? 2
- (vi) Complete the following suitably with one difference between the author's opinion and that of people about gossip. 1
Generally, people do not readily accept _____.



- (vii) “There’s also a physiological distinction to be drawn between active and passive participation in gossip.” (paragraph (4)) 1

Based on the above statement, classify the following sentences as active and passive participation.

Sentence 1 : Ranjan told Raman and Shah the sensational facts he had heard about his friend Vineet from others.

Sentence 2 : Kumar stayed silent while his friends criticized his close friend Vijay in his absence.

- (viii) Why does the author say that gossip is a reflection of relationships ? 1

- (ix) Choose the correct option : 1

..... gossip can ‘stave off loneliness’. (paragraph (6))

The above statement is true as :

- (A) we always enjoy talking ill of others.
- (B) we believe what we read about people in the print media.
- (C) we are free to talk loosely in the absence of the person.
- (D) in order to gossip, you need to feel close to people.

- (x) Complete the following suitably : 1

The author puts forth the fact that man can never _____ gossiping.

2. Read the following passage carefully : 10

- (1) **Introduction** : Humans are social creatures with a deep desire to interact with one another. Recent developments in technology have made it possible for billions of people worldwide to use cell phones to satisfy this need. The current study aims to analyse the impact of smartphone use among various categories of people in Kerala, India. The present study will provide an insight into the extent and magnitude of people’s reliance on smartphones to communicate in this modern age and the dwindling nature of social relationships.



- (2) **Methodology** : A google form created questionnaire was used to gather information on the subject from a sample of participants who were from various districts in Kerala, India.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : Among the 131 study participants, 66 were men and the remaining 65 were women. For convenience, the study considered only the main purpose for which a smartphone is used by any given individual.

(4) **Results** :

S.No	Purpose	Frequency	Percentage
1.	Academic	21	11.11
2.	Communication	56	29.63
3.	Entertainment	48	25.40
4.	Others	64	33.86

Individuals differed in their interests and preferences regarding their choice of communication medium. Some preferred direct conversation, while others conveyed their messages through virtual mediums of communication, that did not involve any face-to-face interaction.

- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : It was observed that individuals were interested in using their smartphones even when they were dining. This constant use can have several disadvantages such as reckless use of mobile phones, including prolonged hours of radiation exposure, over-calorie intake due to binge eating, leading to obesity, and other health problems. It is also a vital tool to achieve social progress.

The use of phones while travelling can sometimes detract from an individual's enjoyment of the serenity of the environment, the scenic beauty of picnic spots, and affect the way an individual behaves and interacts with his or her co-travellers.

- (6) **Conclusion** : It is true that most of the population under different age and gender categories use smartphones every day, but there is no significant fall in the duration spent in direct face-to-face conversation with fellow beings, except in very few individuals. The majority of people agree that traditional face-to-face communication is more comfortable, reliable, and expressive than text messages, phone calls, or electronic mail.



Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Complete the following suitably.

In paragraph (1), the author highlights the use of smartphones to _____.

- (ii) How does the author validate the fact that smartphones take away the joy of beauty around us ?

- (iii) Paragraph (4) includes the phrases, direct communication and virtual communication.

Classify the following sentences as direct and virtual communication :

Sentence 1 : Most of the students attend online classes on mobile phones.

Sentence 2 : He arranged for a get-together to meet his school friends.

- (iv) In paragraph (5), 'By reckless use of mobile phones' the author blames :

- | | |
|---------------------------|------------------------|
| (A) binge eating | (B) mobile phones |
| (C) responsibility of man | (D) demands of society |

- (v) Give two points to support how smartphones make a major impact on man's life.

- (vi) What would the following be classified as ?

There is no significant fall in the duration spent in direct face-to-face conversation.

Select the appropriate response :

- | | |
|------------------------|-------------------------|
| (A) Primary purpose | (B) Secondary objective |
| (C) Method of analysis | (D) Research outcome |

- (vii) 'Technological development is a double-edged sword.'
Analyse the above statement with reference to the text.

- (viii) The study is very relevant in the contemporary times, because :

- | |
|---|
| (A) we are living in the 21 st century. |
| (B) it is an era of IT revolution. |
| (C) mobile phones have penetrated everyone's life. |
| (D) mobile phones are used by students for academic purposes. |



SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) Gossip. All humans partake in some form, despite the age-old adage, *“If you have nothing nice to say, don’t say anything at all.”* Whether it’s workplace chatter, the sharing of family news or group texts between friends, it’s inevitable that anyone who participates in the above, talks about other people.
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- (6) **Conclusion** : It is true that most of the population under different age and gender categories use smartphones every day, but there is no significant fall in the duration spent in direct face-to-face conversation with fellow beings, except in very few individuals. The majority of people agree that traditional face-to-face communication is more comfortable, reliable, and expressive than text messages, phone calls, or electronic mail.



Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Complete the following suitably.

In paragraph (1), the author highlights the use of smartphones to _____.

- (ii) How does the author validate the fact that smartphones take away the joy of beauty around us ?

- (iii) Paragraph (4) includes the phrases, direct communication and virtual communication.

Classify the following sentences as direct and virtual communication :

Sentence 1 : Most of the students attend online classes on mobile phones.

Sentence 2 : He arranged for a get-together to meet his school friends.

- (iv) In paragraph (5), 'By reckless use of mobile phones' the author blames :

- (A) binge eating (B) mobile phones
(C) responsibility of man (D) demands of society

- (v) Give two points to support how smartphones make a major impact on man's life.

- (vi) What would the following be classified as ?

There is no significant fall in the duration spent in direct face-to-face conversation.

Select the appropriate response :

- (A) Primary purpose (B) Secondary objective
(C) Method of analysis (D) Research outcome

- (vii) 'Technological development is a double-edged sword.'
Analyse the above statement with reference to the text.

- (viii) The study is very relevant in the contemporary times, because :

- (A) we are living in the 21st century.
(B) it is an era of IT revolution.
(C) mobile phones have penetrated everyone's life.
(D) mobile phones are used by students for academic purposes.



SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) Gossip. All humans partake in some form, despite the age-old adage, *“If you have nothing nice to say, don’t say anything at all.”* Whether it’s workplace chatter, the sharing of family news or group texts between friends, it’s inevitable that anyone who participates in the above, talks about other people.
- (2) People tend to think of gossip as synonymous with malicious rumours, put-downs, or the breathless propagation of a tabloid scoop. But researchers often define it more broadly as “talking about people who aren’t present,” says an assistant professor of psychology. “It’s something that comes very naturally to us” — an integral part of conversation, information sharing, and even community building.
- (3) “It’s not necessarily negative,” adds a professor of psychology. “It can be positive or neutral.” Some researchers argue that gossip helped our ancestors survive. Evolutionary psychologists first pioneered this idea, comparing gossip to the grooming primates engage in as a means of bonding.
- (4) People are usually resistant to thinking about gossip as anything but bad. It is true that there are some types of gossip that should be avoided, such as gossip that is purely harmful and serves no purpose like mean comments on someone’s way of dressing. In such a scenario no one benefits. Gossip can also be both active and passive. Active gossiping refers to directly sharing negative information about someone else. An active gossiper initiates the conversation and actively spreads it. Passive gossiping on the other hand involves more subtle behaviour like hinting, dropping suggestive comments or participating in gossip by listening without actively contributing, but still allowing the gossip to spread through their presence.



- (5) It's interesting to note that gossiping also says something about relationships people have with one another. The act of gossiping often implies a level of trust and closeness with someone, which are key aspects of a good friendship.
- (6) Research has found that gossip can stave off loneliness, while other studies have found it can facilitate bonding and closeness and serve as a form of entertainment. So, keep on talking. And when your conversation turns to gossip, as it inevitably will, remember that some good can come of it — with the right intentions, of course.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably. 1
..... think of gossip as synonymous with malicious rumours, put-downs in paragraph (2).
By the phrase 'put-downs' the writer means _____.
- (ii) Despite the bad reputation of 'gossip', mention any two benefits that it offers. 2
- (iii) Read and complete the following suitably : 1
The phrase – 'It's something that comes very naturally to us' suggests that gossip should not merely be associated with malicious rumours.
Choose the correct response from the two options to complete the sentence.
The concern this phrase points towards is about
A. that some types of gossip should be avoided.
B. that gossip can be viewed as part of our daily interaction and bonding.
- (iv) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (2). 1
Praise : Commend :: _____ : Malevolent
(A) Scoop
(B) Propagation
(C) Malicious
(D) Conversation
- (v) What type of gossip does the author disapprove of and why ? 2
- (vi) Complete the following suitably with one difference between the author's opinion and that of people about gossip. 1
Generally, people do not readily accept _____.



- (vii) “There’s also a physiological distinction to be drawn between active and passive participation in gossip.” (paragraph (4)) 1

Based on the above statement, classify the following sentences as active and passive participation.

Sentence 1 : Ranjan told Raman and Shah the sensational facts he had heard about his friend Vineet from others.

Sentence 2 : Kumar stayed silent while his friends criticized his close friend Vijay in his absence.

- (viii) Why does the author say that gossip is a reflection of relationships ? 1

- (ix) Choose the correct option : 1

..... gossip can ‘stave off loneliness’. (paragraph (6))

The above statement is true as :

- (A) we always enjoy talking ill of others.
- (B) we believe what we read about people in the print media.
- (C) we are free to talk loosely in the absence of the person.
- (D) in order to gossip, you need to feel close to people.

- (x) Complete the following suitably : 1

The author puts forth the fact that man can never _____ gossiping.

2. Read the following passage carefully : 10

- (1) **Introduction** : Humans are social creatures with a deep desire to interact with one another. Recent developments in technology have made it possible for billions of people worldwide to use cell phones to satisfy this need. The current study aims to analyse the impact of smartphone use among various categories of people in Kerala, India. The present study will provide an insight into the extent and magnitude of people’s reliance on smartphones to communicate in this modern age and the dwindling nature of social relationships.



- (2) **Methodology** : A google form created questionnaire was used to gather information on the subject from a sample of participants who were from various districts in Kerala, India.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : Among the 131 study participants, 66 were men and the remaining 65 were women. For convenience, the study considered only the main purpose for which a smartphone is used by any given individual.

(4) **Results** :

S.No	Purpose	Frequency	Percentage
1.	Academic	21	11.11
2.	Communication	56	29.63
3.	Entertainment	48	25.40
4.	Others	64	33.86

Individuals differed in their interests and preferences regarding their choice of communication medium. Some preferred direct conversation, while others conveyed their messages through virtual mediums of communication, that did not involve any face-to-face interaction.

- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : It was observed that individuals were interested in using their smartphones even when they were dining. This constant use can have several disadvantages such as reckless use of mobile phones, including prolonged hours of radiation exposure, over-calorie intake due to binge eating, leading to obesity, and other health problems. It is also a vital tool to achieve social progress.

The use of phones while travelling can sometimes detract from an individual's enjoyment of the serenity of the environment, the scenic beauty of picnic spots, and affect the way an individual behaves and interacts with his or her co-travellers.

- (6) **Conclusion** : It is true that most of the population under different age and gender categories use smartphones every day, but there is no significant fall in the duration spent in direct face-to-face conversation with fellow beings, except in very few individuals. The majority of people agree that traditional face-to-face communication is more comfortable, reliable, and expressive than text messages, phone calls, or electronic mail.



Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Complete the following suitably.

In paragraph (1), the author highlights the use of smartphones to _____.

- (ii) How does the author validate the fact that smartphones take away the joy of beauty around us ?

- (iii) Paragraph (4) includes the phrases, direct communication and virtual communication.

Classify the following sentences as direct and virtual communication :

Sentence 1 : Most of the students attend online classes on mobile phones.

Sentence 2 : He arranged for a get-together to meet his school friends.

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There is no significant fall in the duration spent in direct face-to-face conversation.

Select the appropriate response :

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| (A) Primary purpose | (B) Secondary objective |
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- (vii) 'Technological development is a double-edged sword.'
Analyse the above statement with reference to the text.

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SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully : 12

- (1) In recent years, air pollution has emerged as one of the most pressing environmental and public health issues in India. Cities like Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru often record Air Quality Indices (AQI) that fall into the 'hazardous' category, posing several health risks to their inhabitants. The thick blanket of smog that shrouds these urban areas is composed of harmful pollutants such as particulate material (PM 2.5 and PM 10), nitrogen dioxide (NO₂) and sulphur dioxide (SO₂). These pollutants originate from various sources including vehicular emissions, industrial activities and construction dust.
- (2) The constant emission of pollutants from vehicles, industrial activities and construction works exacerbate the problem. Residents of these cities are often seen wearing masks and using air purifiers in a desperate attempt to mitigate the effects of polluted air. The 'urban haze' not only affects physical health but also impacts mental well-being. Studies indicate that prolonged exposure to high pollution levels can lead to respiratory issues, such as cardiovascular diseases and even cognitive decline.
- (3) Furthermore, children and the elderly are the most vulnerable groups. Children, with their developing respiratory systems, and the elderly, often with pre-existing health conditions face the brunt of this environmental crisis. Schools frequently shut down during peak pollution periods, disrupting education and daily life. The economic cost of air pollution is staggering, with increased healthcare expenses and lost labour productivity. Businesses also suffer as employees' health issues lead to increased absenteeism and decreased efficiency.



- (4) Government initiatives, such as the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) aim at reducing air pollution levels across the country. However, these measures require robust implementation and public cooperation to be effective. Simple actions like reducing vehicle use, promoting public transportation and adopting cleaner technologies can significantly alleviate the situation. Additionally, the enforcement of stricter emission norms for industries and vehicles is crucial. Public awareness campaigns can play a pivotal role in encouraging others to adopt environmentally friendly practices.
- (5) The role of technology in combating air pollution is also noteworthy. Innovative solutions such as air quality monitoring systems, green buildings and electric vehicles are gaining attraction. These technologies not only help in reducing pollution but also promote sustainable development. Urban planning that incorporates green spaces can also mitigate the effects of pollution by improving air quality and providing residents with a healthier living environment.
- (6) As we navigate this challenge, it is imperative to remember that the solution lies not just in policy changes but also in the behavioural shifts of individuals. Embracing a lifestyle that prioritizes environmental health will pave the way for a cleaner, healthier India. Collective efforts and sustained commitments are crucial for ensuring breathable air for future generations. It is a shared responsibility that requires action from every segment of society from policy makers to ordinary citizens.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) According to paragraph (1), what components make up the 'urban haze' that envelops Indian cities ? 1
- (ii) The writer refers to air pollution as a 'public health issue' in paragraph (1) because : 1
- (A) it is a threat to the physical well-being of the people.
- (B) it disrupts the daily activities of urban inhabitants.
- (C) it leads to the closure of schools during peak pollution periods.
- (D) it disrupts industrial activities and construction works.



- (iii) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (2). 1
blanket : cover :: extended : _____
(A) composed
(B) attempted
(C) declined
(D) prolonged
- (iv) Complete the following sentence suitably (Paragraph (2)) : 1
'The prolonged exposure to high pollution levels leads to cognitive decline' indicates that it impacts _____.
(A) mental health
(B) economic development
(C) respiratory functions
(D) mobility
- (v) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (3), to prove the following : 1
"Children and the elderly are the most vulnerable groups affected by air pollution."
- (vi) Complete the following suitably with one advantage with reference to paragraph (4) : 1
Implementing stricter emission norms for vehicles can help to _____.
- (vii) Assess the potential challenges and benefits of promoting public transportation as a solution to air pollution, as outlined in paragraph (4). 2
- (viii) What is the significance of urban planning in mitigating air pollution according to paragraph (5) ? 1
- (ix) How does technology help in resolving the problem of air pollution ? 1
- (x) Why does the author say that just the policy change is not the solution ? 2



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) **Introduction** : In the digital age, social media has become an integral part of daily life, profoundly affecting how individuals interact and perceive the world. This case study aims to analyze the impact of social media on the mental health of different age groups in Indian society and explore the implications for overall well-being.
- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among individuals across various age groups, ranging from teenagers to seniors, to determine their social media usage patterns. Participants were asked to indicate the amount of time they spend on social media platforms and describe their feelings and experiences related to its use. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different age demographics.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : The survey encompassed a comprehensive examination of social media habits, including not only the frequency and duration of usage but also the emotional and psychological effects of social media engagement. Participants were encouraged to articulate their experiences, providing invaluable insights into the multifaceted nature of social media's impact on mental health.
- (4) **Results** : The survey results revealed interesting insights into social media usage and its effects on mental health among different age groups. Teenagers are deeply entrenched in exploring their self image and forming their identity. They are heavily reliant on their peer relationships and are vulnerable to the social aspects of online platforms to connect with friends and share experiences. As a result, their usage is higher than that of other age groups.

S.No.	Age group	%	Average daily usage (hours)	Reported effects
1.	Teenagers	72	3.5	Anxiety, peer pressure, cyberbullying
2.	Young Adults	68	3.0	Stress, depression, Fear of Missing Out (FOMO)
3.	Middle-aged	54	2.0	Information overload, sleep disturbance
4.	Seniors	32	1.5	Loneliness, sense of connection, digital fatigue



- (5) **Implications for Interventions :** By discerning the diverse effects of social media among different age groups, policy makers and mental health practitioners can tailor interventions to address specific demographic needs, e.g., educational campaigns aimed at teenagers could empower them to navigate social media more responsibly, while support groups for seniors can enhance their digital literacy and reduce feelings of loneliness.
- (6) **Conclusion :** The survey outcomes serve as a roadmap for designing targeted interventions that not only cater to diverse demographic needs but also promote mental well-being. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building healthier online communities and promoting sustainable digital practices for generations to come.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably :
In the introduction, the researches link the digital age with the impact of social media on mental health to highlight _____. 1
- (ii) Choose the correct option :
To examine social media usage patterns across various age groups in detail and assess the mental health implications will be classified as : 1
- (A) Primary purpose
(B) Method of analysis
(C) Secondary purpose
(D) Research outcome
- (iii) Give two points to support why it is likely that social media usage was a key factor in the study on mental health. 2
- (iv) Paragraph (3) includes the words – ‘emotional and psychological’. Classify the following sentences as ‘emotional’ or ‘psychological’. 1
- (A) Educational campaigns aimed at teenagers could empower them to navigate social media more responsibly.
(B) Support groups for seniors can enhance their digital literacy and reduce feelings of loneliness.



(v) Read the following text :

1

Rahul has a tendency to spend late night hours engaging in social media to avoid missing out on latest updates on different events. His friend, Rajneesh spends many hours on social media due to peer pressure whereas their close friend, Dr. Sharma uses social media to stay connected with his near and dear ones.

Select the option that identifies the correct demographic Rahul, Rajneesh and Dr. Sharma belong to :

- (A) Rahul – middle-aged, Rajneesh – young adult, Dr. Sharma – teenager.
- (B) Rahul – young adult, Rajneesh – middle-aged, Dr. Sharma – senior.
- (C) Rahul – middle-aged, Rajneesh – young adult, Dr. Sharma – senior.
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(vi) Why is the average daily usage of social media highest among teenagers ?

1

(vii) According to paragraph (5), analyze how targeted interventions based on the diverse effects of social media on different age groups can lead to improved mental health outcomes.

2

(viii) Select the appropriate response :

What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insight from the study ?

1

- (A) increase profitability through enhanced social media marketing.
- (B) build healthier online communities.
- (C) reduce the cost of healthcare services.
- (D) expand the range of available social media platforms.



SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully : 12

- (1) In recent years, air pollution has emerged as one of the most pressing environmental and public health issues in India. Cities like Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru often record Air Quality Indices (AQI) that fall into the 'hazardous' category, posing several health risks to their inhabitants. The thick blanket of smog that shrouds these urban areas is composed of harmful pollutants such as particulate material (PM 2.5 and PM 10), nitrogen dioxide (NO₂) and sulphur dioxide (SO₂). These pollutants originate from various sources including vehicular emissions, industrial activities and construction dust.
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- (3) Furthermore, children and the elderly are the most vulnerable groups. Children, with their developing respiratory systems, and the elderly, often with pre-existing health conditions face the brunt of this environmental crisis. Schools frequently shut down during peak pollution periods, disrupting education and daily life. The economic cost of air pollution is staggering, with increased healthcare expenses and lost labour productivity. Businesses also suffer as employees' health issues lead to increased absenteeism and decreased efficiency.



- (4) Government initiatives, such as the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) aim at reducing air pollution levels across the country. However, these measures require robust implementation and public cooperation to be effective. Simple actions like reducing vehicle use, promoting public transportation and adopting cleaner technologies can significantly alleviate the situation. Additionally, the enforcement of stricter emission norms for industries and vehicles is crucial. Public awareness campaigns can play a pivotal role in encouraging others to adopt environmentally friendly practices.
- (5) The role of technology in combating air pollution is also noteworthy. Innovative solutions such as air quality monitoring systems, green buildings and electric vehicles are gaining attraction. These technologies not only help in reducing pollution but also promote sustainable development. Urban planning that incorporates green spaces can also mitigate the effects of pollution by improving air quality and providing residents with a healthier living environment.
- (6) As we navigate this challenge, it is imperative to remember that the solution lies not just in policy changes but also in the behavioural shifts of individuals. Embracing a lifestyle that prioritizes environmental health will pave the way for a cleaner, healthier India. Collective efforts and sustained commitments are crucial for ensuring breathable air for future generations. It is a shared responsibility that requires action from every segment of society from policy makers to ordinary citizens.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) According to paragraph (1), what components make up the 'urban haze' that envelops Indian cities ? 1
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2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) **Introduction** : In the digital age, social media has become an integral part of daily life, profoundly affecting how individuals interact and perceive the world. This case study aims to analyze the impact of social media on the mental health of different age groups in Indian society and explore the implications for overall well-being.
- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among individuals across various age groups, ranging from teenagers to seniors, to determine their social media usage patterns. Participants were asked to indicate the amount of time they spend on social media platforms and describe their feelings and experiences related to its use. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different age demographics.
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SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

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- (1) **Introduction** : In the digital age, social media has become an integral part of daily life, profoundly affecting how individuals interact and perceive the world. This case study aims to analyze the impact of social media on the mental health of different age groups in Indian society and explore the implications for overall well-being.
- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among individuals across various age groups, ranging from teenagers to seniors, to determine their social media usage patterns. Participants were asked to indicate the amount of time they spend on social media platforms and describe their feelings and experiences related to its use. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different age demographics.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : The survey encompassed a comprehensive examination of social media habits, including not only the frequency and duration of usage but also the emotional and psychological effects of social media engagement. Participants were encouraged to articulate their experiences, providing invaluable insights into the multifaceted nature of social media's impact on mental health.
- (4) **Results** : The survey results revealed interesting insights into social media usage and its effects on mental health among different age groups. Teenagers are deeply entrenched in exploring their self image and forming their identity. They are heavily reliant on their peer relationships and are vulnerable to the social aspects of online platforms to connect with friends and share experiences. As a result, their usage is higher than that of other age groups.

S.No.	Age group	%	Average daily usage (hours)	Reported effects
1.	Teenagers	72	3.5	Anxiety, peer pressure, cyberbullying
2.	Young Adults	68	3.0	Stress, depression, Fear of Missing Out (FOMO)
3.	Middle-aged	54	2.0	Information overload, sleep disturbance
4.	Seniors	32	1.5	Loneliness, sense of connection, digital fatigue



- (5) **Implications for Interventions :** By discerning the diverse effects of social media among different age groups, policy makers and mental health practitioners can tailor interventions to address specific demographic needs, e.g., educational campaigns aimed at teenagers could empower them to navigate social media more responsibly, while support groups for seniors can enhance their digital literacy and reduce feelings of loneliness.
- (6) **Conclusion :** The survey outcomes serve as a roadmap for designing targeted interventions that not only cater to diverse demographic needs but also promote mental well-being. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building healthier online communities and promoting sustainable digital practices for generations to come.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably :
In the introduction, the researches link the digital age with the impact of social media on mental health to highlight _____. 1
- (ii) Choose the correct option :
To examine social media usage patterns across various age groups in detail and assess the mental health implications will be classified as : 1
- (A) Primary purpose
(B) Method of analysis
(C) Secondary purpose
(D) Research outcome
- (iii) Give two points to support why it is likely that social media usage was a key factor in the study on mental health. 2
- (iv) Paragraph (3) includes the words – ‘emotional and psychological’. Classify the following sentences as ‘emotional’ or ‘psychological’. 1
- (A) Educational campaigns aimed at teenagers could empower them to navigate social media more responsibly.
(B) Support groups for seniors can enhance their digital literacy and reduce feelings of loneliness.



(v) Read the following text :

1

Rahul has a tendency to spend late night hours engaging in social media to avoid missing out on latest updates on different events. His friend, Rajneesh spends many hours on social media due to peer pressure whereas their close friend, Dr. Sharma uses social media to stay connected with his near and dear ones.

Select the option that identifies the correct demographic Rahul, Rajneesh and Dr. Sharma belong to :

- (A) Rahul – middle-aged, Rajneesh – young adult, Dr. Sharma – teenager.
- (B) Rahul – young adult, Rajneesh – middle-aged, Dr. Sharma – senior.
- (C) Rahul – middle-aged, Rajneesh – young adult, Dr. Sharma – senior.
- (D) Rahul – young adult, Rajneesh – teenager, Dr. Sharma – senior.

(vi) Why is the average daily usage of social media highest among teenagers ?

1

(vii) According to paragraph (5), analyze how targeted interventions based on the diverse effects of social media on different age groups can lead to improved mental health outcomes.

2

(viii) Select the appropriate response :

What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insight from the study ?

1

- (A) increase profitability through enhanced social media marketing.
- (B) build healthier online communities.
- (C) reduce the cost of healthcare services.
- (D) expand the range of available social media platforms.



SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) In recent years, the rise of digital education has revolutionized the way students in India learn. With the advent of high speed internet and widespread smartphone use, online learning platforms have become increasingly popular. These platforms offer a wide range of courses, from academic subjects to vocational skills, enabling students to learn at their own pace and convenience. The flexibility of digital education is beneficial where traditional classroom learning cannot take place. Many students and educators have now embraced this new mode of learning, recognizing its potential.
- (2) However, this shift to digital learning is not without its challenges. One major issue is the digital divide, which refers to the gap between those who have access to the internet and those who do not. In rural areas and among economically disadvantaged communities, many students lack the necessary devices or reliable internet connections to participate in online classes. This has led to concerns about unequal access to education and the potential for widening educational disparities. For instance, a study by the National Sample Survey Office revealed that only 24% of Indian households have internet access, highlighting the extent of the digital divide.
- (3) Another significant challenge is the effectiveness of digital learning. While some students thrive in an online environment, others struggle with the lack of face-to-face interaction and the self-discipline required to stay on track. Teachers also face difficulties in both engaging students as well as providing personalized feedback in a virtual setting. The absence of a structured classroom environment can lead to distractions and reduced motivation among students. Furthermore, the lack of direct social interaction impacts social skills and emotional development.



- (4) To address these issues, various initiatives have been launched. Government programmes aim to provide digital devices and improve internet connectivity in far-off areas. Educational platforms are developing more interactive and engaging content to enhance the online learning experience. Blended learning models, which combine online and offline methods, are being explored to offer a more balanced approach. The government's Digital India campaign has also made strides in promoting digital literacy and bridging the technological gap.
- (5) The potential of digital education extends beyond formal schooling. Online platforms provide opportunities for lifelong learning, allowing individuals to acquire new skills and knowledge throughout their lives. This is particularly relevant in a rapidly changing job market, where continuous upskilling and reskilling are essential. Digital education empowers individuals to take control of this learning journey, breaking down traditional barriers to education. Moreover, it offers flexibility for working professionals and homemakers, who can access educational resources without disrupting their daily schedules.
- (6) As we navigate this digital revolution in education, it is crucial to ensure that no one is left behind. Bridging the digital divide, supporting teachers and students, and fostering an inclusive and effective online learning environment are essential to realizing the full potential of digital education in India. Policy-makers, educators, and the private sector must collaborate to create sustainable solutions that address the diverse needs of the population. Only then can we harness the power of digital education.



Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) According to paragraph (1), what advantages do online learning platforms offer to students ? 1
- (ii) How does the author describe the 'digital divide' in the context of education ? 1
- (iii) Read the following sentence. 1
'In rural areas and among economically disadvantaged communities, many students lack the necessary devices or reliable internet connections.'
The concern the above statement points towards is _____.
Choose the correct response from the two options to complete the sentence.
A. an increasing gap between those living in cities and those living in villages
B. a growing divide in the educational opportunities for children
- (iv) How does the lack of social interaction in digital learning affect students' overall development ? 1
- (v) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (3), to prove the following : 1
The absence of a structured classroom environment can lead to distractions among students.
- (vi) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (4) : 1
flexibility : adaptability :: integrated : _____.
(A) paced (B) blended
(C) balanced (D) created
- (vii) Give one benefit of continuous upskilling and reskilling. 1
- (viii) Assess the potential challenges or benefits of lifelong learning through digital platforms, as outlined in paragraph (5). 2
- (ix) To realize the full potential of digital India, it is important to _____ an environment that provides education for all. 2
(A) refrain (B) replicate
(C) nurture (D) commemorate
- (x) We can harness the power of digital education if 1
(A) educators and policy-makers help create sustainable solutions.
(B) we shift back to traditional classrooms.
(C) we further extend the digital divide.
(D) we control the internet connections.



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) **Introduction** : In the face of rapid urbanization, effective waste management has become a critical issue in Indian cities. This case study aims to analyze the recycling practices among different demographics in urban India and their implications for sustainable urban development.
- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among residents of various urban areas, ranging from teenagers to elderly citizens, to determine their waste management and recycling habits. Participants were asked to indicate their preferred methods of waste disposal and recycling and provide reasons for their choices. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different age groups.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : The survey comprehensively examined waste disposal habits. Participants were encouraged to share the reasons for their selections, providing invaluable insight into waste management behaviour.
- (4) **Results** : The survey results revealed interesting insights into waste management and recycling practices among different age groups.

S. No.	Age group for preference	%	Preferred Method	Reasons for Preference
1.	Teenagers	55%	Recycling	Environment awareness, school programme, peer pressure
2.	Young adults	68%	Recycling & Reuse	Sustainability, convenience, social responsibility
3.	Middle-aged	73%	Segregation at source	Health concerns, civic responsibility, easy to manage
4.	Elderly	62%	Traditional disposal	Habit, lack of awareness, convenience



- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : By discerning the diverse preferences among different age groups, policy-makers and environmental activists can not only make interventions to address specific demographic needs, but also delve into the underlying motivations and influences guiding these choices. For instance, targeting educational campaigns towards teenagers and young adults could empower them to adopt sustainable waste management practices. Concurrently, efforts to enhance the infrastructure for segregation at source and provide incentives for recycling could improve overall waste management.
- (6) **Conclusion** : The survey outcomes serve as a roadmap for designing targeted interventions that not only cater to diverse demographic needs but also foster a culture of sustainability. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building cleaner and more sustainable urban environments for future generations.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably : 1
In the introduction, the researcher links rapid urbanization with waste management by highlighting that _____.
- (ii) What would the following be classified as ? 1
To examine waste management practices across various age groups in detail.
Select the appropriate response.
(A) Primary purpose
(B) Secondary objective
(C) Method of analysis
(D) Research outcome
- (iii) Give two points to support why it is likely that recycling was given as an option to the survey participants to choose from, in the study on waste management practices. 2



- (iv) Paragraph (5) includes words like ‘motivations’ and ‘interventions’.
Classify the following sentences as motivation or intervention. 1
- (A) Targeting educational campaigns towards teenagers and young adults could empower them to adopt sustainable waste management practices.
- (B) Efforts to enhance the infrastructure for segregation at source.
- (v) Read the following text : 1
- Radhika actively participates in school programmes that promote recycling. Her neighbour, Ragini, prefers recycling and reusing items for their environmental benefits. However, their neighbour Mrs. Gupta sticks to traditional disposal methods out of habit.
- Select the option that identifies the correct demographic they belong to :
- (A) Radhika – middle-aged; Ragini – young adult;
Mrs. Gupta – elderly
- (B) Radhika – teenager; Ragini – young adult;
Mrs. Gupta – elderly
- (C) Radhika – young adult; Ragini – elderly;
Mrs. Gupta – middle-aged
- (D) Radhika – elderly; Ragini – middle-aged;
Mrs. Gupta – teenager
- (vi) Why is the percentage to adopt recycling methods higher among young adults ? 1
- (vii) Analyze how targeted interventions based on the diverse waste management preferences of different age groups can lead to improved environmental outcomes. (paragraph 5) 2
- (viii) What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insights from the study ? 1
- (A) Increase profitability through enhanced recycling infrastructure
- (B) Build cleaner urban environments
- (C) Reduce the cost of waste management
- (D) Expand the range of recycling programmes available



SECTION A
Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) In recent years, the rise of digital education has revolutionized the way students in India learn. With the advent of high speed internet and widespread smartphone use, online learning platforms have become increasingly popular. These platforms offer a wide range of courses, from academic subjects to vocational skills, enabling students to learn at their own pace and convenience. The flexibility of digital education is beneficial where traditional classroom learning cannot take place. Many students and educators have now embraced this new mode of learning, recognizing its potential.
- (2) However, this shift to digital learning is not without its challenges. One major issue is the digital divide, which refers to the gap between those who have access to the internet and those who do not. In rural areas and among economically disadvantaged communities, many students lack the necessary devices or reliable internet connections to participate in online classes. This has led to concerns about unequal access to education and the potential for widening educational disparities. For instance, a study by the National Sample Survey Office revealed that only 24% of Indian households have internet access, highlighting the extent of the digital divide.
- (3) Another significant challenge is the effectiveness of digital learning. While some students thrive in an online environment, others struggle with the lack of face-to-face interaction and the self-discipline required to stay on track. Teachers also face difficulties in both engaging students as well as providing personalized feedback in a virtual setting. The absence of a structured classroom environment can lead to distractions and reduced motivation among students. Furthermore, the lack of direct social interaction impacts social skills and emotional development.



- (4) To address these issues, various initiatives have been launched. Government programmes aim to provide digital devices and improve internet connectivity in far-off areas. Educational platforms are developing more interactive and engaging content to enhance the online learning experience. Blended learning models, which combine online and offline methods, are being explored to offer a more balanced approach. The government's Digital India campaign has also made strides in promoting digital literacy and bridging the technological gap.
- (5) The potential of digital education extends beyond formal schooling. Online platforms provide opportunities for lifelong learning, allowing individuals to acquire new skills and knowledge throughout their lives. This is particularly relevant in a rapidly changing job market, where continuous upskilling and reskilling are essential. Digital education empowers individuals to take control of this learning journey, breaking down traditional barriers to education. Moreover, it offers flexibility for working professionals and homemakers, who can access educational resources without disrupting their daily schedules.
- (6) As we navigate this digital revolution in education, it is crucial to ensure that no one is left behind. Bridging the digital divide, supporting teachers and students, and fostering an inclusive and effective online learning environment are essential to realizing the full potential of digital education in India. Policy-makers, educators, and the private sector must collaborate to create sustainable solutions that address the diverse needs of the population. Only then can we harness the power of digital education.



Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) According to paragraph (1), what advantages do online learning platforms offer to students ? 1
- (ii) How does the author describe the 'digital divide' in the context of education ? 1
- (iii) Read the following sentence. 1
'In rural areas and among economically disadvantaged communities, many students lack the necessary devices or reliable internet connections.'
The concern the above statement points towards is _____.
Choose the correct response from the two options to complete the sentence.
A. an increasing gap between those living in cities and those living in villages
B. a growing divide in the educational opportunities for children
- (iv) How does the lack of social interaction in digital learning affect students' overall development ? 1
- (v) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (3), to prove the following : 1
The absence of a structured classroom environment can lead to distractions among students.
- (vi) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (4) : 1
flexibility : adaptability :: integrated : _____.
(A) paced (B) blended
(C) balanced (D) created
- (vii) Give one benefit of continuous upskilling and reskilling. 1
- (viii) Assess the potential challenges or benefits of lifelong learning through digital platforms, as outlined in paragraph (5). 2
- (ix) To realize the full potential of digital India, it is important to _____ an environment that provides education for all. 2
(A) refrain (B) replicate
(C) nurture (D) commemorate
- (x) We can harness the power of digital education if 1
(A) educators and policy-makers help create sustainable solutions.
(B) we shift back to traditional classrooms.
(C) we further extend the digital divide.
(D) we control the internet connections.



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) **Introduction** : In the face of rapid urbanization, effective waste management has become a critical issue in Indian cities. This case study aims to analyze the recycling practices among different demographics in urban India and their implications for sustainable urban development.
- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among residents of various urban areas, ranging from teenagers to elderly citizens, to determine their waste management and recycling habits. Participants were asked to indicate their preferred methods of waste disposal and recycling and provide reasons for their choices. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different age groups.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : The survey comprehensively examined waste disposal habits. Participants were encouraged to share the reasons for their selections, providing invaluable insight into waste management behaviour.
- (4) **Results** : The survey results revealed interesting insights into waste management and recycling practices among different age groups.

S. No.	Age group for preference	%	Preferred Method	Reasons for Preference
1.	Teenagers	55%	Recycling	Environment awareness, school programme, peer pressure
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- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : By discerning the diverse preferences among different age groups, policy-makers and environmental activists can not only make interventions to address specific demographic needs, but also delve into the underlying motivations and influences guiding these choices. For instance, targeting educational campaigns towards teenagers and young adults could empower them to adopt sustainable waste management practices. Concurrently, efforts to enhance the infrastructure for segregation at source and provide incentives for recycling could improve overall waste management.
- (6) **Conclusion** : The survey outcomes serve as a roadmap for designing targeted interventions that not only cater to diverse demographic needs but also foster a culture of sustainability. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building cleaner and more sustainable urban environments for future generations.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably : 1
In the introduction, the researcher links rapid urbanization with waste management by highlighting that _____.
- (ii) What would the following be classified as ? 1
To examine waste management practices across various age groups in detail.
Select the appropriate response.
(A) Primary purpose
(B) Secondary objective
(C) Method of analysis
(D) Research outcome
- (iii) Give two points to support why it is likely that recycling was given as an option to the survey participants to choose from, in the study on waste management practices. 2



- (iv) Paragraph (5) includes words like ‘motivations’ and ‘interventions’.
Classify the following sentences as motivation or intervention. 1
- (A) Targeting educational campaigns towards teenagers and young adults could empower them to adopt sustainable waste management practices.
- (B) Efforts to enhance the infrastructure for segregation at source.
- (v) Read the following text : 1
- Radhika actively participates in school programmes that promote recycling. Her neighbour, Ragini, prefers recycling and reusing items for their environmental benefits. However, their neighbour Mrs. Gupta sticks to traditional disposal methods out of habit.
- Select the option that identifies the correct demographic they belong to :
- (A) Radhika – middle-aged; Ragini – young adult;
Mrs. Gupta – elderly
- (B) Radhika – teenager; Ragini – young adult;
Mrs. Gupta – elderly
- (C) Radhika – young adult; Ragini – elderly;
Mrs. Gupta – middle-aged
- (D) Radhika – elderly; Ragini – middle-aged;
Mrs. Gupta – teenager
- (vi) Why is the percentage to adopt recycling methods higher among young adults ? 1
- (vii) Analyze how targeted interventions based on the diverse waste management preferences of different age groups can lead to improved environmental outcomes. (paragraph 5) 2
- (viii) What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insights from the study ? 1
- (A) Increase profitability through enhanced recycling infrastructure
- (B) Build cleaner urban environments
- (C) Reduce the cost of waste management
- (D) Expand the range of recycling programmes available



SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) In recent years, the rise of digital education has revolutionized the way students in India learn. With the advent of high speed internet and widespread smartphone use, online learning platforms have become increasingly popular. These platforms offer a wide range of courses, from academic subjects to vocational skills, enabling students to learn at their own pace and convenience. The flexibility of digital education is beneficial where traditional classroom learning cannot take place. Many students and educators have now embraced this new mode of learning, recognizing its potential.
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- (ii) How does the author describe the 'digital divide' in the context of education ? 1
- (iii) Read the following sentence. 1
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Choose the correct response from the two options to complete the sentence.
A. an increasing gap between those living in cities and those living in villages
B. a growing divide in the educational opportunities for children
- (iv) How does the lack of social interaction in digital learning affect students' overall development ? 1
- (v) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (3), to prove the following : 1
The absence of a structured classroom environment can lead to distractions among students.
- (vi) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (4) : 1
flexibility : adaptability :: integrated : _____.
(A) paced (B) blended
(C) balanced (D) created
- (vii) Give one benefit of continuous upskilling and reskilling. 1
- (viii) Assess the potential challenges or benefits of lifelong learning through digital platforms, as outlined in paragraph (5). 2
- (ix) To realize the full potential of digital India, it is important to _____ an environment that provides education for all. 2
(A) refrain (B) replicate
(C) nurture (D) commemorate
- (x) We can harness the power of digital education if 1
(A) educators and policy-makers help create sustainable solutions.
(B) we shift back to traditional classrooms.
(C) we further extend the digital divide.
(D) we control the internet connections.



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

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- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among residents of various urban areas, ranging from teenagers to elderly citizens, to determine their waste management and recycling habits. Participants were asked to indicate their preferred methods of waste disposal and recycling and provide reasons for their choices. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different age groups.
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- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : By discerning the diverse preferences among different age groups, policy-makers and environmental activists can not only make interventions to address specific demographic needs, but also delve into the underlying motivations and influences guiding these choices. For instance, targeting educational campaigns towards teenagers and young adults could empower them to adopt sustainable waste management practices. Concurrently, efforts to enhance the infrastructure for segregation at source and provide incentives for recycling could improve overall waste management.
- (6) **Conclusion** : The survey outcomes serve as a roadmap for designing targeted interventions that not only cater to diverse demographic needs but also foster a culture of sustainability. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building cleaner and more sustainable urban environments for future generations.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage :

- (i) Complete the following suitably : 1
In the introduction, the researcher links rapid urbanization with waste management by highlighting that _____.
- (ii) What would the following be classified as ? 1
To examine waste management practices across various age groups in detail.
Select the appropriate response.
(A) Primary purpose
(B) Secondary objective
(C) Method of analysis
(D) Research outcome
- (iii) Give two points to support why it is likely that recycling was given as an option to the survey participants to choose from, in the study on waste management practices. 2



- (iv) Paragraph (5) includes words like ‘motivations’ and ‘interventions’.
Classify the following sentences as motivation or intervention. 1
- (A) Targeting educational campaigns towards teenagers and young adults could empower them to adopt sustainable waste management practices.
- (B) Efforts to enhance the infrastructure for segregation at source.
- (v) Read the following text : 1
- Radhika actively participates in school programmes that promote recycling. Her neighbour, Ragini, prefers recycling and reusing items for their environmental benefits. However, their neighbour Mrs. Gupta sticks to traditional disposal methods out of habit.
- Select the option that identifies the correct demographic they belong to :
- (A) Radhika – middle-aged; Ragini – young adult;
Mrs. Gupta – elderly
- (B) Radhika – teenager; Ragini – young adult;
Mrs. Gupta – elderly
- (C) Radhika – young adult; Ragini – elderly;
Mrs. Gupta – middle-aged
- (D) Radhika – elderly; Ragini – middle-aged;
Mrs. Gupta – teenager
- (vi) Why is the percentage to adopt recycling methods higher among young adults ? 1
- (vii) Analyze how targeted interventions based on the diverse waste management preferences of different age groups can lead to improved environmental outcomes. (paragraph 5) 2
- (viii) What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insights from the study ? 1
- (A) Increase profitability through enhanced recycling infrastructure
- (B) Build cleaner urban environments
- (C) Reduce the cost of waste management
- (D) Expand the range of recycling programmes available



SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) In the heart of a bustling city, amidst the cacophony of traffic and the incessant buzz of urban life, there lies a sanctuary of tranquility — a sprawling public park that offers a respite from the daily grind. This park, with its verdant lawns and serene water features, attracts visitors from all walks of life, seeking solace and rejuvenation.
- (2) A public park is an area of open space owned and maintained by the local government, providing recreational opportunities for citizens. Public parks are places of leisure integrated into the community and are generally considered safe places. They provide essential environmental, aesthetic, and recreational benefits to our cities.
- (3) As the sun rises, joggers and fitness enthusiasts can be seen navigating the winding paths, their faces set with determination. Meanwhile, yoga practitioners find their own quiet corners, their movements graceful and meditative. The air is filled with the chirping of birds and the rustling of leaves, creating a natural symphony that soothes the soul.
- (4) By midday, the park transforms into a lively gathering spot. Families spread out picnic blankets, sharing meals and laughter, while children chase each other across the grass, their joyous shouts echoing through the trees. Elderly couples sit on benches, reminiscing about days gone by as they watch the world go by.



- (5) As dusk approaches, the park takes on a magical quality. The setting sun casts a golden hue over the landscape, and the water features glisten in the fading light. Street performers and musicians add to the enchantment, drawing crowds with their captivating acts. The park, now aglow with lanterns, becomes a haven for stargazers and dreamers alike.
- (6) In this urban oasis, people find a connection with nature and one another, a reminder that amidst the chaos of modern life, moments of peace and tranquility are still within reach. Especially in cities, parks encourage native flora and fauna to thrive.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Why does the writer refer to the park as a ‘sanctuary of tranquility’ in paragraph (1) ? 1
- (ii) Why is it important for governments to set up public parks ? 1
- (iii) According to the passage, what activities can be observed in the park during the early morning hours ? 1
- (iv) Describe the transformation of the park by midday. 1
- (v) Complete the following suitably. 1
- The park at dusk is described as taking on a magical quality because of _____.
- (A) the setting sun casting a golden hue and water features glistening
- (B) the bustling activities of joggers and fitness enthusiasts
- (C) the lively gathering of families and children playing
- (D) the quiet solitude and meditation of yoga practitioners



- (vi) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (4) to prove the following : 1
- Elderly couples feel a sense of nostalgia.
- (vii) In the line “The park, now aglow with lanterns, becomes a haven for stargazers and dreamers alike,” what does the phrase ‘haven for stargazers and dreamers’ refer to ? (Paragraph 5) 2
- (viii) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph (6). 1
- urban life : chaos : : park : _____
- (A) connection
- (B) reminder
- (C) tranquility
- (D) oasis
- (ix) Why is it fair to say that the statement “In this urban oasis, people find a connection with nature and one another” from paragraph (6) is significant ? 1
- (A) It highlights the park’s role in promoting physical activities.
- (B) It emphasizes the park’s importance as a social and natural retreat.
- (C) It mocks the idea of nature within a bustling city.
- (D) It underplays the park’s significance in modern life.
- (x) Assess the potential benefits of an urban park. 2



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) **Introduction** : As the world grapples with climate change, renewable energy has emerged as a crucial solution. This case study aims to analyze the increasing use of renewable energy in India, its adoption across different sectors, and the implications for society and the environment.
- (2) **Methodology** : A survey was conducted among households, businesses, and industries across various regions in India. Participants were asked about their primary source of energy (traditional fossil fuels or renewable energy) and the reasons for their preferences. The data was then analyzed to identify trends and patterns among different demographics and sectors.
- (3) **Survey Examination** : The survey encompassed a comprehensive examination of energy consumption habits, not only focusing on the preferred sources of energy but also delving into the underlying motivations and influences guiding these choices. Beyond mere preference, participants were encouraged to articulate the reasons behind their selections, providing invaluable insights into the multifaceted nature of energy consumption.
- (4) **Results** : The survey results revealed interesting insights into the energy preferences among different groups :

S. No.	Demographic Preferences	%	Preferred Source	Reasons for Preference
1.	Households	62%	Renewable	Environmental concerns, cost savings, government incentives
2.	Small Businesses	55%	Renewable	Cost efficiency, public image, sustainability
3.	Large Industries	48%	Renewable	Long-term savings, corporate responsibility compliance
4.	Rural Areas	71%	Renewable	Accessibility, reliability, local employment opportunities
5.	Urban Areas	58%	Renewable	Environmental awareness, incentives, modern infrastructure



- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : By discerning the diverse preferences among different demographics, policymakers, and energy providers, one can tailor interventions to address specific needs. For instance, increasing government incentives and subsidies for renewable energy can encourage more households and businesses to adopt sustainable practices. Concurrently, efforts to improve the infrastructure for renewable energy can enhance its reliability and accessibility. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building a cleaner and more sustainable future for generations to come.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Complete the following suitably : 1
In the introduction, the researcher links climate change with the rise of renewable energy by highlighting _____.
(ii) What would the following be classified as ?
To examine energy preferences across various demographics in detail, and assess their implications. 1
Select the appropriate response :
(A) Primary purpose
(B) Method of analysis
(C) Secondary objective
(D) Research outcome
(iii) Mention the two steps adopted in the survey methodology. 2
(iv) Paragraph (3) includes the words – ‘motivations’ and ‘influences’.
Classify the following sentences as influence or motivation. 1
Sentence 1 : Government incentives lead households to prefer renewable energy over traditional fossil fuels.
Sentence 2 : The desire for long-term savings makes large industries choose renewable energy.



(v) Read the following text :

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Rajan, a rural household head, prefers using solar panels for energy due to their reliability and the local employment opportunities they provide. His neighbour, Rama, a small business owner, values renewable energy for its cost efficiency and sustainability. Meanwhile Suresh, who runs a large industry, opts for renewable energy due to corporate responsibility and compliance with regulations.

Select the option that identifies the correct demographic they belong to.

- (A) Rajan – household worker; Rama – small business owner; Suresh – large industry owner
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- (vi) Although both rural and urban areas prefer renewable energy, why is the preference percentage higher among rural areas ?
- (vii) Analyse how targeted interventions based on diverse energy preferences of different demographics can lead to improved environmental outcomes. (Paragraph (5))
- (viii) What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insights from the study ?
- (A) increase profitability through enhanced renewable infrastructure
 - (B) build a sustainable future
 - (C) reduce the cost of energy
 - (D) expand the range of renewable energy products available

1

2

1



SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) In the heart of a bustling city, amidst the cacophony of traffic and the incessant buzz of urban life, there lies a sanctuary of tranquility — a sprawling public park that offers a respite from the daily grind. This park, with its verdant lawns and serene water features, attracts visitors from all walks of life, seeking solace and rejuvenation.
- (2) A public park is an area of open space owned and maintained by the local government, providing recreational opportunities for citizens. Public parks are places of leisure integrated into the community and are generally considered safe places. They provide essential environmental, aesthetic, and recreational benefits to our cities.
- (3) As the sun rises, joggers and fitness enthusiasts can be seen navigating the winding paths, their faces set with determination. Meanwhile, yoga practitioners find their own quiet corners, their movements graceful and meditative. The air is filled with the chirping of birds and the rustling of leaves, creating a natural symphony that soothes the soul.
- (4) By midday, the park transforms into a lively gathering spot. Families spread out picnic blankets, sharing meals and laughter, while children chase each other across the grass, their joyous shouts echoing through the trees. Elderly couples sit on benches, reminiscing about days gone by as they watch the world go by.



- (5) As dusk approaches, the park takes on a magical quality. The setting sun casts a golden hue over the landscape, and the water features glisten in the fading light. Street performers and musicians add to the enchantment, drawing crowds with their captivating acts. The park, now aglow with lanterns, becomes a haven for stargazers and dreamers alike.
- (6) In this urban oasis, people find a connection with nature and one another, a reminder that amidst the chaos of modern life, moments of peace and tranquility are still within reach. Especially in cities, parks encourage native flora and fauna to thrive.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Why does the writer refer to the park as a ‘sanctuary of tranquility’ in paragraph (1) ? 1
- (ii) Why is it important for governments to set up public parks ? 1
- (iii) According to the passage, what activities can be observed in the park during the early morning hours ? 1
- (iv) Describe the transformation of the park by midday. 1
- (v) Complete the following suitably. 1
- The park at dusk is described as taking on a magical quality because of _____.
- (A) the setting sun casting a golden hue and water features glistening
- (B) the bustling activities of joggers and fitness enthusiasts
- (C) the lively gathering of families and children playing
- (D) the quiet solitude and meditation of yoga practitioners



- (vi) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph (4) to prove the following : 1
- Elderly couples feel a sense of nostalgia.
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2. Read the following passage carefully :

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- (1) **Introduction** : As the world grapples with climate change, renewable energy has emerged as a crucial solution. This case study aims to analyze the increasing use of renewable energy in India, its adoption across different sectors, and the implications for society and the environment.
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- (5) **Implications for Interventions** : By discerning the diverse preferences among different demographics, policymakers, and energy providers, one can tailor interventions to address specific needs. For instance, increasing government incentives and subsidies for renewable energy can encourage more households and businesses to adopt sustainable practices. Concurrently, efforts to improve the infrastructure for renewable energy can enhance its reliability and accessibility. By harnessing the insights gleaned from this study, stakeholders can collaboratively work towards building a cleaner and more sustainable future for generations to come.

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(vi) Although both rural and urban areas prefer renewable energy, why is the preference percentage higher among rural areas ?

1

(vii) Analyse how targeted interventions based on diverse energy preferences of different demographics can lead to improved environmental outcomes. (Paragraph (5))

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(viii) What is the ultimate goal for stakeholders, based on the insights from the study ?

1

- (A) increase profitability through enhanced renewable infrastructure
- (B) build a sustainable future
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SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

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1

2

1



SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) Often, people are getting their news online as the convenience and accessibility of online news is difficult to compete with.
- (2) Physical newspapers are typically large, need to be folded and aren't always free, making them an overall hassle. With virtual media outlets being available to nearly everybody at the click of a button, it comes as no surprise that it's grown to be a dominant form of news consumption. However, it's important for readers to consider exactly what they're consuming when getting their news through an app versus a paper, namely the influence of an algorithm.
- (3) A search algorithm is a set of rules made to put forward content the reader is more likely to engage with and filter out what they will ignore. Based on one's viewing history, an app or service determines what kind of content the user enjoys, then recommends similar content from that point onwards. Algorithms give the viewer what they want, that's undeniable, but it's also the problem.
- (4) Digital media experts warn readers to be cautious of how an algorithm processes content. These systems show a reader more of what they want, but in the process, they block out any pieces that aren't in sync with their observed beliefs for the sake of customer service. The result is a person who is always given the same type of content, rarely venturing outside of their own viewpoints.



- (5) There is, fortunately, a way for readers to still get their news without risking the entrapment of an algorithm: classic print newspapers which are not limited by any ruleset constantly tailoring the words offered to the reader. News in print needs to satisfy every type of reader with only one copy, allowing it to offer a wide scope of topics. Printed news offers its viewership more freedom over what they choose to read.
- (6) While an algorithm purposely chooses and narrows potential news, a physical paper's diversity grants its news a more exploratory nature. Taking the time to engage with every part of a physical paper puts a variety of subjects, views and information on display for readers.
- (7) It'd be naive to believe that print newspapers are completely free from bias or a certain degree of filtering. Still, a physical newspaper will almost never be as narrow in scope as the suggestions of a digital media outlet will be.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Online news is becoming popular because it's 1
- (A) economically affordable.
- (B) readily accessible.
- (C) less cumbersome.
- (D) more interesting.
- (ii) The phrase 'venturing outside of their own viewpoints' in para 4 most nearly means 1
- (A) stepping into someone's shoes.
- (B) challenging others' opinions.
- (C) combining traditional beliefs with modern ideology.
- (D) moving away from one's personal opinions.



- (iii) Complete the sentence with evidence from the text. 1
Online readers are unaware that the news they read on a digital platform is
- (iv) Share evidence from the text in about 40 words to support the view that though algorithms give the reader what they want to read, they are also the problem. 2
- (v) Why according to the writer is reading news online becoming increasingly popular ? 2
- (vi) State two reasons in support of why a newspaper is a better source of news than online apps. 2
- (vii) From the passage we understand that the writer concedes that newspapers too are ... 1
- (viii) The passage suggests that the reader while reading news online must be 1
(A) focused
(B) discerning
(C) indifferent
(D) attentive
- (ix) Read the headlines A – E given below : 1
(A) NEWSPAPERS – FREEDOM OF SPEECH
(B) INTERNET – THE NEWS ENTERTAINER
(C) ONLINE NEWS – A LIMITED PERCEPTION
(D) NEWSPAPER VS ONLINE NEWS APPS
(E) NEWS – A BIASED PERSPECTIVE

Identify the option that displays the headline that does not correspond with occurrences in the passage.



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) In a rapidly changing world, transition from school to work has become more complex and challenging for young people, as finding employment is difficult for the youth. If academic studies may be an excellent path to successful career and lives, other types of education like 'Vocational Education and Training (VET) programmes are more than ever being emphasized by governments globally to support work-ready professionals with relevant on-the-job experience to match the needs of various industries.
- (2) According to the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC), India aims to skill 400 million people by 2025. Vocational training programmes, such as Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) provide training in fields such as engineering, health care, hospitality, construction and more. According to NSDC estimates, India is expected to witness significant job creation. With the help of this training, opportunities for self-employment have been enhanced. As of July 2021, over 1.5 million candidates have been placed in various jobs after acquiring vocational training.
- (3) Vocational training programmes also encourage entrepreneurship by providing aspiring entrepreneurs with the knowledge and skills required to establish and operate their own businesses. The NSDC states that out of the 12 million people entering the workforce in India every year, only 4.5 million are skilled, highlighting the need for further vocational training initiatives. Vocational training plays a significant role in India by addressing the skill gap, improving employability, fostering entrepreneurship, and driving economic growth. This contributes to the nation's overall development and individual prosperity.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) What are the problems faced by many young people when they shift from school to work ?

1

- | | |
|------------------------|--------------------|
| (A) Finding employment | (B) Transition |
| (C) Loneliness | (D) Social anxiety |



- (ii) Why are governments promoting Vocational Education and Training programmes ? 1
- (iii) Infer why the National Skill Development Corporation of India has increased its efforts to skill 400 million people in 2025. Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (iv) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words, to support the view that vocational training improves self-employment. 2
- (v) Identify the entrepreneur from the three people who has acquired vocational training. 1
- (A) Ravi : I am working as a carpenter and getting very high wages.
- (B) Narain : I have acquired the skill of cooking and will work for an established hotel.
- (C) Bani : After doing a course in fashion designing, I have opened my own boutique.
- (vi) How does vocational training help in bridging the skill gap ? 1
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately.
The NSDC states that less than half the people entering the workforce in India are skilled so _____. 1
- (viii) State True or False : 1
The title 'Improve Your Skills, Gain Better Jobs' is appropriate for this passage.

SECTION B

Creative Writing Skills

(18 marks)

Note : All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

3. Attempt any **one** of the two, (a) and (b), in about 50 words. 4
- (a) The Trips and Treks Club of Ravindra High School is organizing a trip for grade 11 students to take them all to Paninagar. As Ravi/Reena, the Club Senior School Prefect, draft a notice for your school notice board informing the students to be seated at 5 pm in the auditorium to listen to the instructions for the event. Invent necessary details.

OR



SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

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10

- (1) In a rapidly changing world, transition from school to work has become more complex and challenging for young people, as finding employment is difficult for the youth. If academic studies may be an excellent path to successful career and lives, other types of education like 'Vocational Education and Training (VET) programmes are more than ever being emphasized by governments globally to support work-ready professionals with relevant on-the-job experience to match the needs of various industries.
- (2) According to the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC), India aims to skill 400 million people by 2025. Vocational training programmes, such as Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) provide training in fields such as engineering, health care, hospitality, construction and more. According to NSDC estimates, India is expected to witness significant job creation. With the help of this training, opportunities for self-employment have been enhanced. As of July 2021, over 1.5 million candidates have been placed in various jobs after acquiring vocational training.
- (3) Vocational training programmes also encourage entrepreneurship by providing aspiring entrepreneurs with the knowledge and skills required to establish and operate their own businesses. The NSDC states that out of the 12 million people entering the workforce in India every year, only 4.5 million are skilled, highlighting the need for further vocational training initiatives. Vocational training plays a significant role in India by addressing the skill gap, improving employability, fostering entrepreneurship, and driving economic growth. This contributes to the nation's overall development and individual prosperity.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) What are the problems faced by many young people when they shift from school to work ?

1

- | | |
|------------------------|--------------------|
| (A) Finding employment | (B) Transition |
| (C) Loneliness | (D) Social anxiety |



- (ii) Why are governments promoting Vocational Education and Training programmes ? 1
- (iii) Infer why the National Skill Development Corporation of India has increased its efforts to skill 400 million people in 2025. Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (iv) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words, to support the view that vocational training improves self-employment. 2
- (v) Identify the entrepreneur from the three people who has acquired vocational training. 1
- (A) Ravi : I am working as a carpenter and getting very high wages.
- (B) Narain : I have acquired the skill of cooking and will work for an established hotel.
- (C) Bani : After doing a course in fashion designing, I have opened my own boutique.
- (vi) How does vocational training help in bridging the skill gap ? 1
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately.
The NSDC states that less than half the people entering the workforce in India are skilled so _____. 1
- (viii) State True or False : 1
The title 'Improve Your Skills, Gain Better Jobs' is appropriate for this passage.



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SECTION A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully :

12

- (1) Often, people are getting their news online as the convenience and accessibility of online news is difficult to compete with.
- (2) Physical newspapers are typically large, need to be folded and aren't always free, making them an overall hassle. With virtual media outlets being available to nearly everybody at the click of a button, it comes as no surprise that it's grown to be a dominant form of news consumption. However, it's important for readers to consider exactly what they're consuming when getting their news through an app versus a paper, namely the influence of an algorithm.
- (3) A search algorithm is a set of rules made to put forward content the reader is more likely to engage with and filter out what they will ignore. Based on one's viewing history, an app or service determines what kind of content the user enjoys, then recommends similar content from that point onwards. Algorithms give the viewer what they want, that's undeniable, but it's also the problem.
- (4) Digital media experts warn readers to be cautious of how an algorithm processes content. These systems show a reader more of what they want, but in the process, they block out any pieces that aren't in sync with their observed beliefs for the sake of customer service. The result is a person who is always given the same type of content, rarely venturing outside of their own viewpoints.



- (5) There is, fortunately, a way for readers to still get their news without risking the entrapment of an algorithm: classic print newspapers which are not limited by any ruleset constantly tailoring the words offered to the reader. News in print needs to satisfy every type of reader with only one copy, allowing it to offer a wide scope of topics. Printed news offers its viewership more freedom over what they choose to read.
- (6) While an algorithm purposely chooses and narrows potential news, a physical paper's diversity grants its news a more exploratory nature. Taking the time to engage with every part of a physical paper puts a variety of subjects, views and information on display for readers.
- (7) It'd be naive to believe that print newspapers are completely free from bias or a certain degree of filtering. Still, a physical newspaper will almost never be as narrow in scope as the suggestions of a digital media outlet will be.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) Online news is becoming popular because it's 1
- (A) economically affordable.
- (B) readily accessible.
- (C) less cumbersome.
- (D) more interesting.
- (ii) The phrase 'venturing outside of their own viewpoints' in para 4 most nearly means 1
- (A) stepping into someone's shoes.
- (B) challenging others' opinions.
- (C) combining traditional beliefs with modern ideology.
- (D) moving away from one's personal opinions.



- (iii) Complete the sentence with evidence from the text. 1
Online readers are unaware that the news they read on a digital platform is
- (iv) Share evidence from the text in about 40 words to support the view that though algorithms give the reader what they want to read, they are also the problem. 2
- (v) Why according to the writer is reading news online becoming increasingly popular ? 2
- (vi) State two reasons in support of why a newspaper is a better source of news than online apps. 2
- (vii) From the passage we understand that the writer concedes that newspapers too are ... 1
- (viii) The passage suggests that the reader while reading news online must be 1
(A) focused
(B) discerning
(C) indifferent
(D) attentive
- (ix) Read the headlines A – E given below : 1
(A) NEWSPAPERS – FREEDOM OF SPEECH
(B) INTERNET – THE NEWS ENTERTAINER
(C) ONLINE NEWS – A LIMITED PERCEPTION
(D) NEWSPAPER VS ONLINE NEWS APPS
(E) NEWS – A BIASED PERSPECTIVE

Identify the option that displays the headline that does not correspond with occurrences in the passage.



2. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) In a rapidly changing world, transition from school to work has become more complex and challenging for young people, as finding employment is difficult for the youth. If academic studies may be an excellent path to successful career and lives, other types of education like 'Vocational Education and Training (VET) programmes are more than ever being emphasized by governments globally to support work-ready professionals with relevant on-the-job experience to match the needs of various industries.
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- (ii) Why are governments promoting Vocational Education and Training programmes ? 1
- (iii) Infer why the National Skill Development Corporation of India has increased its efforts to skill 400 million people in 2025. Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (iv) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words, to support the view that vocational training improves self-employment. 2
- (v) Identify the entrepreneur from the three people who has acquired vocational training. 1
- (A) Ravi : I am working as a carpenter and getting very high wages.
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- (C) Bani : After doing a course in fashion designing, I have opened my own boutique.
- (vi) How does vocational training help in bridging the skill gap ? 1
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately.
The NSDC states that less than half the people entering the workforce in India are skilled so _____. 1
- (viii) State True or False : 1
The title 'Improve Your Skills, Gain Better Jobs' is appropriate for this passage.

SECTION B

Creative Writing Skills

(18 marks)

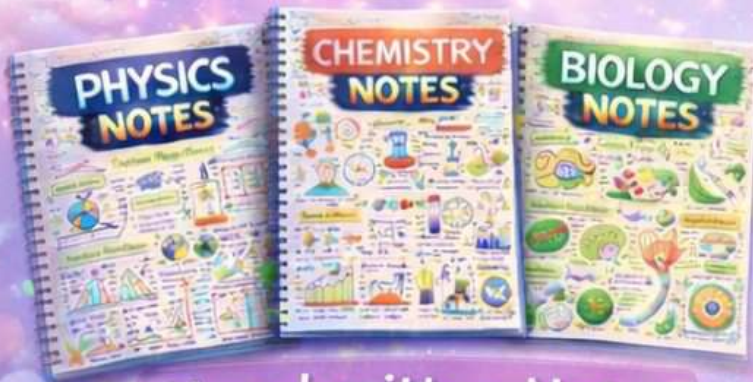
Note : All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

3. Attempt any **one** of the two, (a) and (b), in about 50 words. 4
- (a) You are Anvesh/Anvita Khemka Head boy/girl of, Ajanta Public School. The Principal wants you to draft a notice for the school notice board to inform students of classes VIII and IX about the educational trip to New Bread Factory on Sunday. Draft the notice. Invent necessary details.

OR

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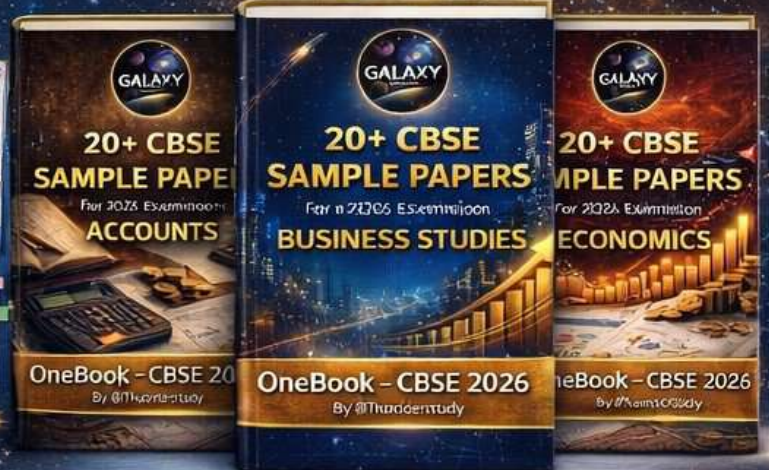
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BACKBENCHER NOTES

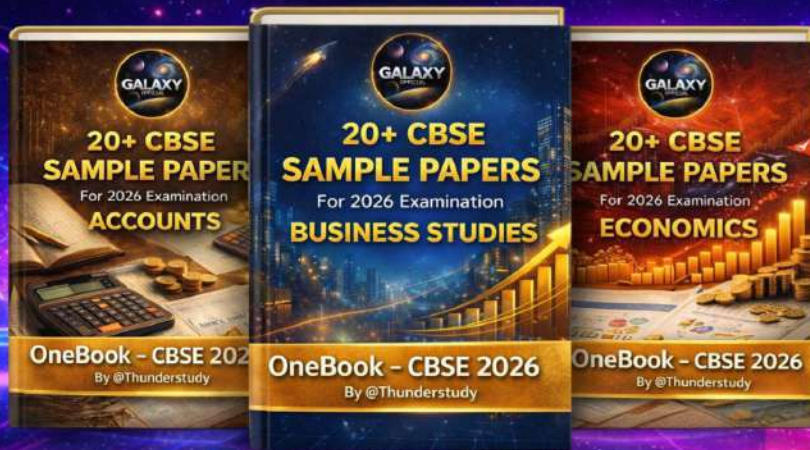
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